Team 3

P2 Process Book: AUI

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Spring 2026

AGENDA

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Search for Opportunity: Team Step

We originally brainstormed 22 apps that have high-frequency, consistent, and repetitive interactions to potentially design AUIs for

1. Instacart
2. Grubhub/UberEats (bring you directly to checkout)
3. Zoom (Bring you directly to your meeting)
4. Canvas (Bring you to your class if you pull it up at “classtime”)
5. Google/Apple Maps (Automatically suggests directions to a location coming up in your calendar/Copy and paste address from other apps)
6. Google/Apple Calendar (Automatically suggests locations/people)
7. Fidelity/Vanguard (Automatically suggests best stocks/etfs to buy when you deposit $$)
8. Gradescope (bring you to classes with upcoming deadlines, or when grades are just released)
9. Piazza
10. Ed
11. Life360
12. Lyft
13. Google Translate (Track your location - automatically translate to the language of the country you’re in from your native/phone language)
    a. XE doing the same thing with currency
14. Photoshop (organize tools for easier navigation based on your usage/most used tools)
15. Slack (some sort of organization of most used/least used channels and workspaces)
16. Alarm apps (frequently used/high confidence times/alarms at the top)
17. Disney app
18. The RealReal
19. Unity/Godot (similar to Photoshop)
20. Discord
21. Ticket master
22. Target

Search for Opportunity: Individual Step

After coming up with our 22 ideas, we took 2 each to explore more in depth. The apps we chose to look into were:

- Slack, Fidelity, Canvas, Gradescope, Banking Apps (ex: Capital One), Spotify, Grubhub, Weather, Photoshop, The RealReal, Target and Ticketmaster

After each researching 2 apps, we got together and ranked each of the apps based on financial viability, technical feasibility, and how closely it aligned with the goal of the project (to “renovate” an already existing UI/feature using AI)

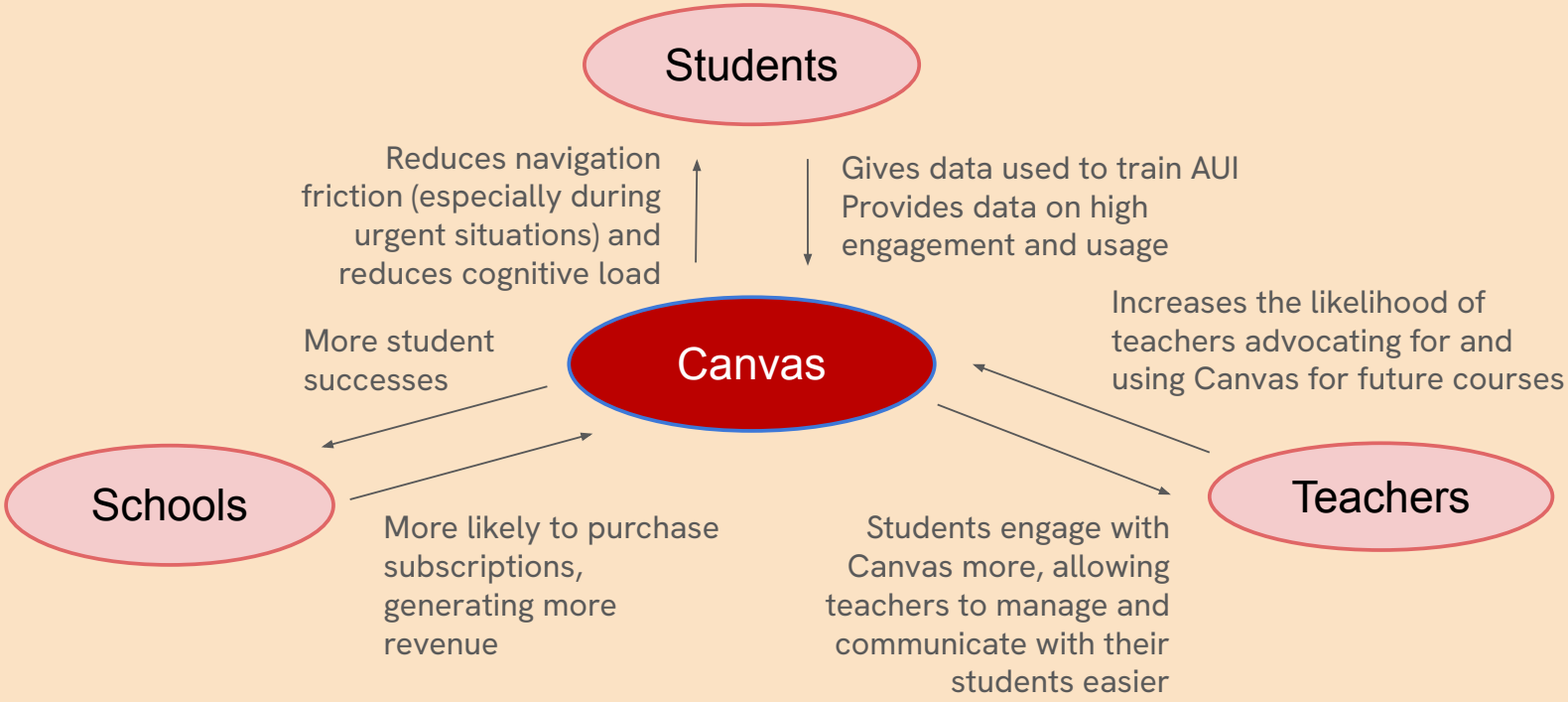
Search for Opportunity: Researched App Rankings

	Researched App		Financial viability		Technical feasibility		Desire/Acceptance		Rank
1	Slack - sort by recommended channels		4		5		5		14
2	Fidelity - suggestions for what ETFs users invest in for their 401k	closer to new feature	2		3	financial analysis/prediction of how markets will do is not a guaranteed solved problem.	2	Risky	7
3	Canvas - placing older courses at the bottom/put frequently clicked on courses at the top. also sort side tabs of each class by frequently clicked. to do list also ranked by day		4		5		4		13
4	Gradescope - smart tab sorting. brings you straight to the most recently unsubmitted due assignment when you click on a class		2		3		2		7
5	Banking Apps - suggest new widgets for most frequently used categories		4		5		4		13
6	Spotify - recognizes which categories (ex: audiobooks) you do and don't click and cycle in new categories/playlists that users are more likely to click on	Closer to new feature? Leaning away from this	5		3		5		13
7	Grubhub - Re-ordering recommendation (customers that order the same meal and re-order a lot). Suggestion for specific time opening app, suggest the order that user most likely reorder at that time		5		5		5		15
8	Weather - see the previous day's temperature	maybe not really AI							0
9	Photoshop - if a user opens a repeated template or file type, they can automatically suggest that import type. another idea: as users engage with specific tools, the tool bar reorganizes itself/sorts by most used (they can choose whether to activate this or not)		4		5		3		12
10	The RealReal - rather than the home page being generic, they should tailor it to user's specific actions (i.e. if they open the app and every time they click on saved searches)		5		5		5		15
11	Target- suggested pop up for consistently reordered items within a time period. one - tap checkout		5		5		5		15
12	Ticketmaster- predicts concerts/artists users typically go to and prices of tickets. automatically suggests the concert and seat that you would likely go to		5		5		5		15

Note: All rankings were made on a scale of Low (1) to High (5)

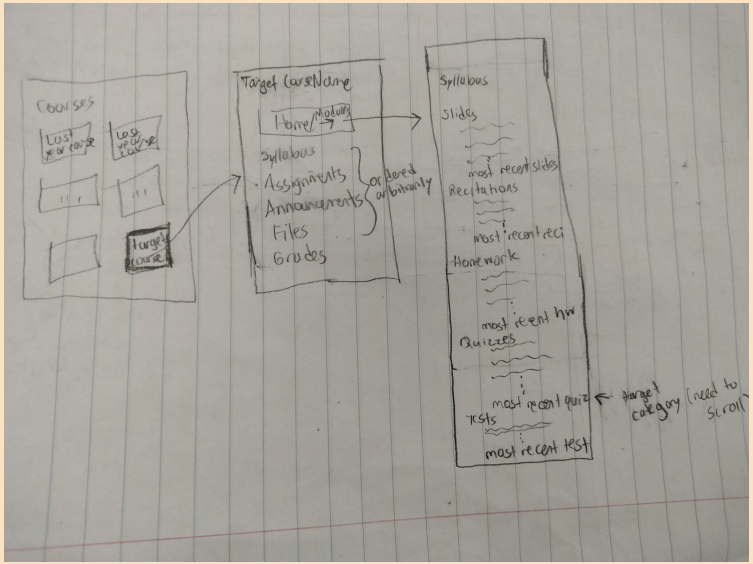
After ranking each idea, we all picked between the ideas with 13+ score, and thus selected our final idea: Canvas

Draft Value Flow Model

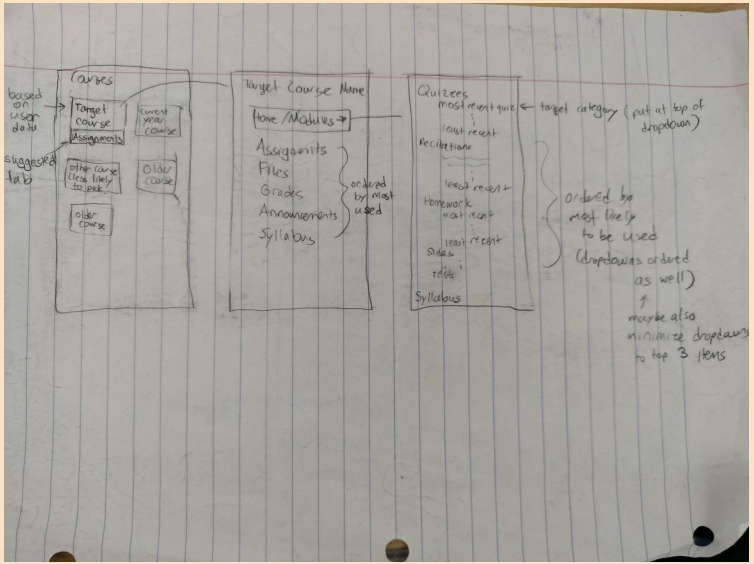


Low-Fidelity Wireframes

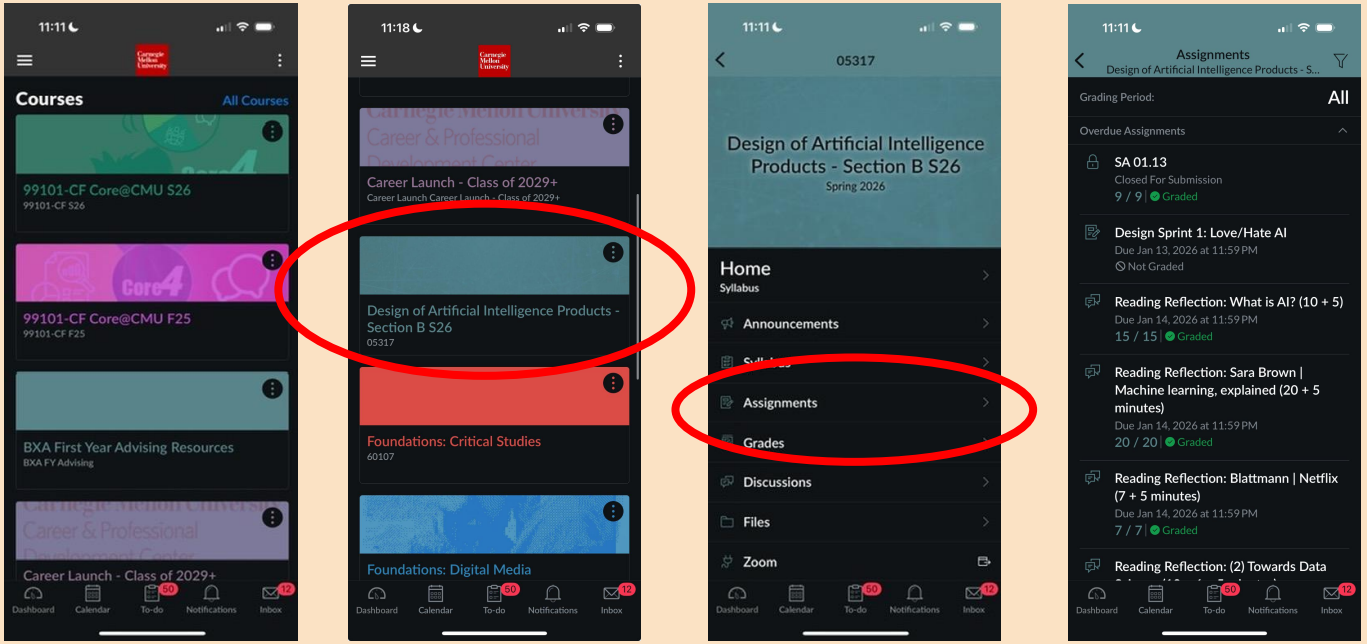
Before



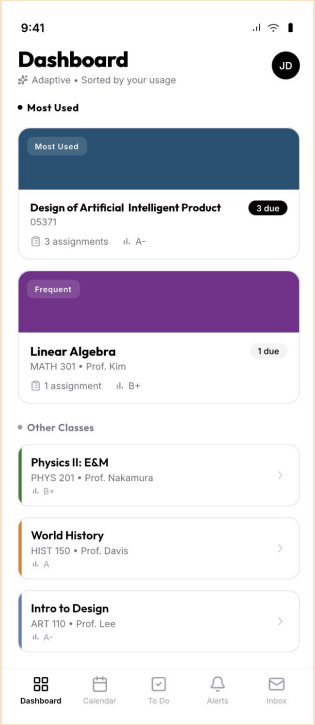
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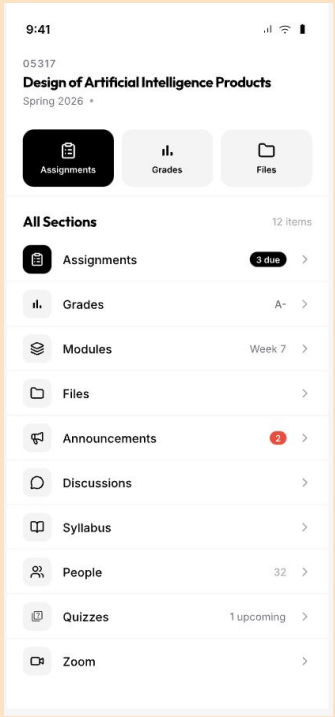


Mid-Fidelity Wireframe (Before)



Mid-Fidelity Wireframe (After)

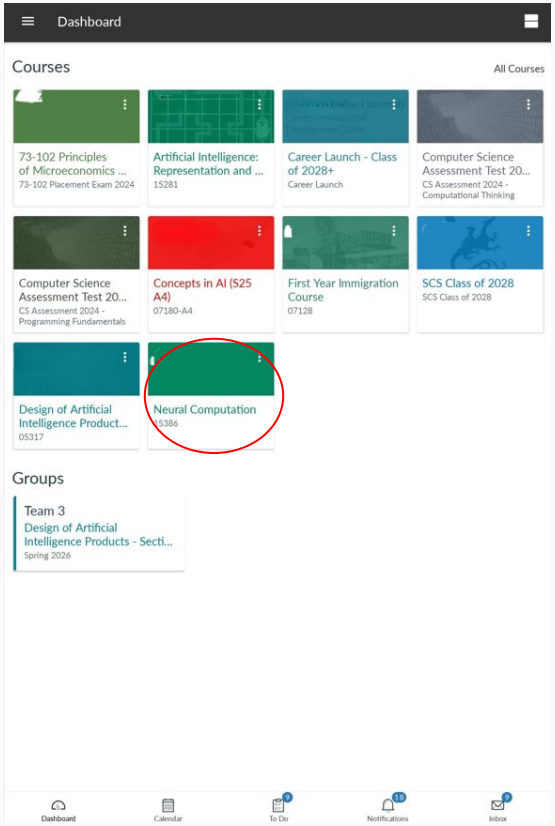


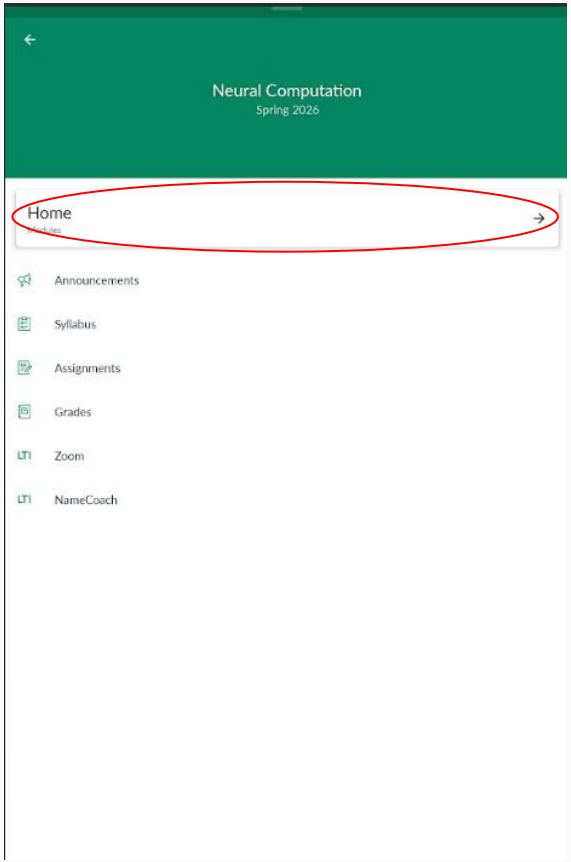


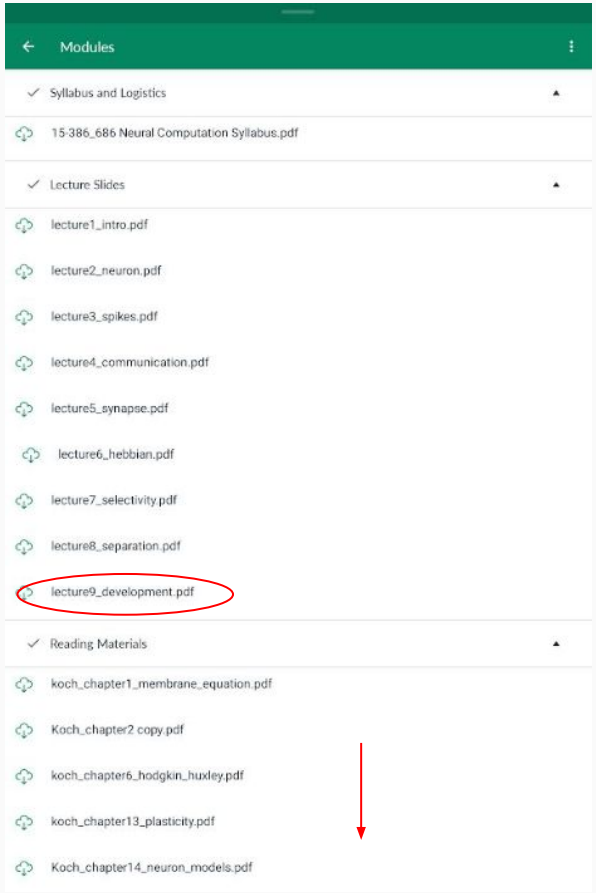
Draft AUI Pitch

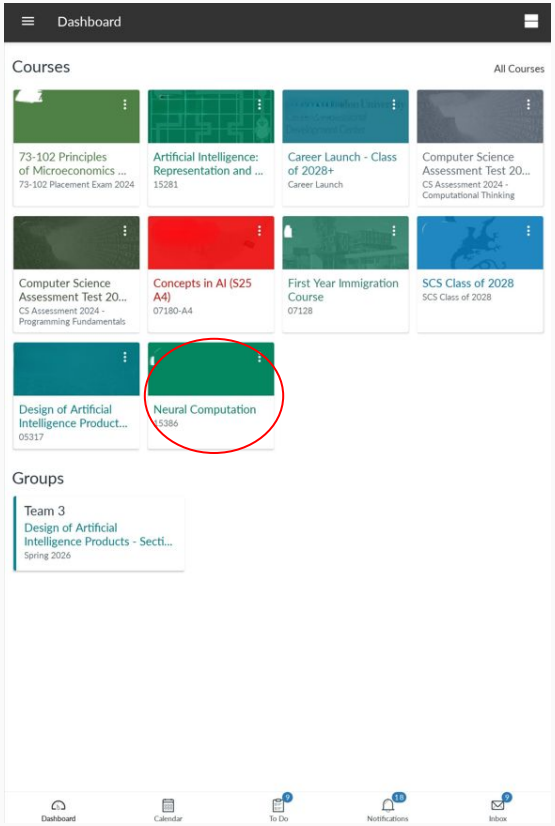
P2: Canvas AUI Draft Pitch

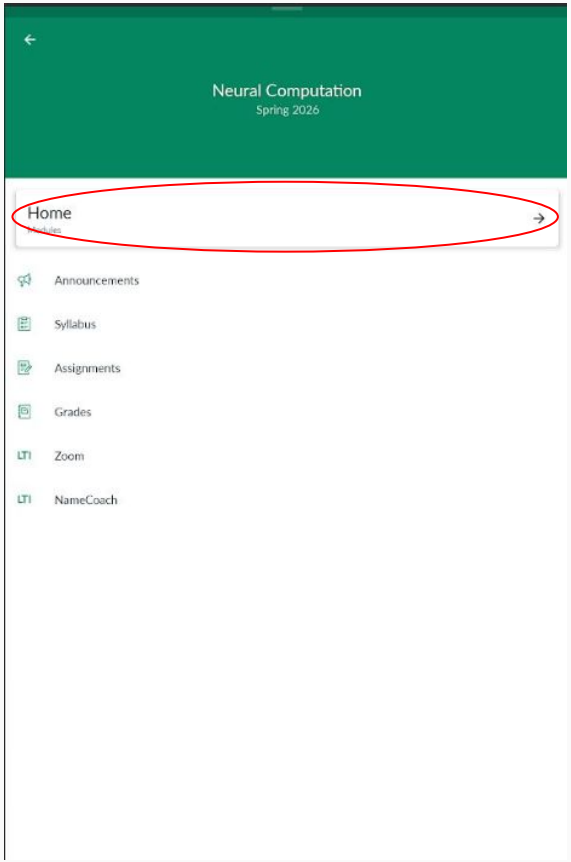
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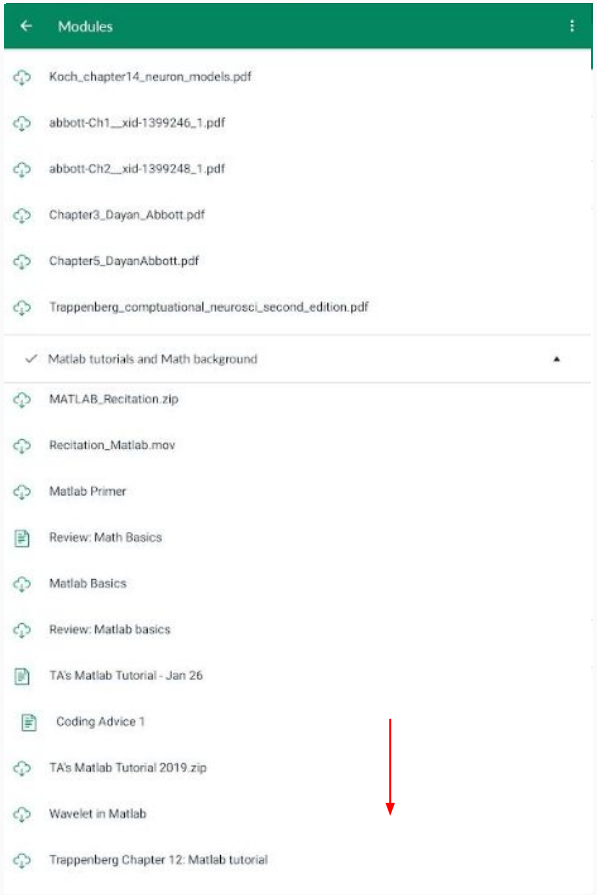

Dashboard
Courses
All Courses
73-102 Principles of Microeconomics ...
73-102 Placement Exam 2024
Artificial Intelligence: Representation and ...
15281
Career Launch - Class of 2028+
Career Launch
Computer Science Assessment Test 20...
CS Assessment 2024 - Computational Thinking
Computer Science Assessment Test 20...
CS Assessment 2024 - Programming Fundamentals
Concepts in AI (S25 A4)
07180-A4
First Year Immigration Course
07128
SCS Class of 2028
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05317
Neural Computation
15386
Groups
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Design of Artificial Intelligence Products - Secti...
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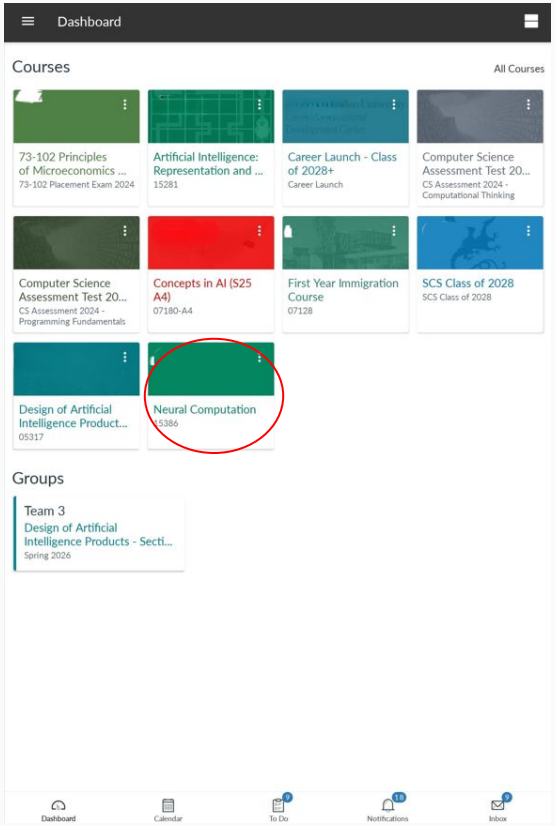

Neural Computation
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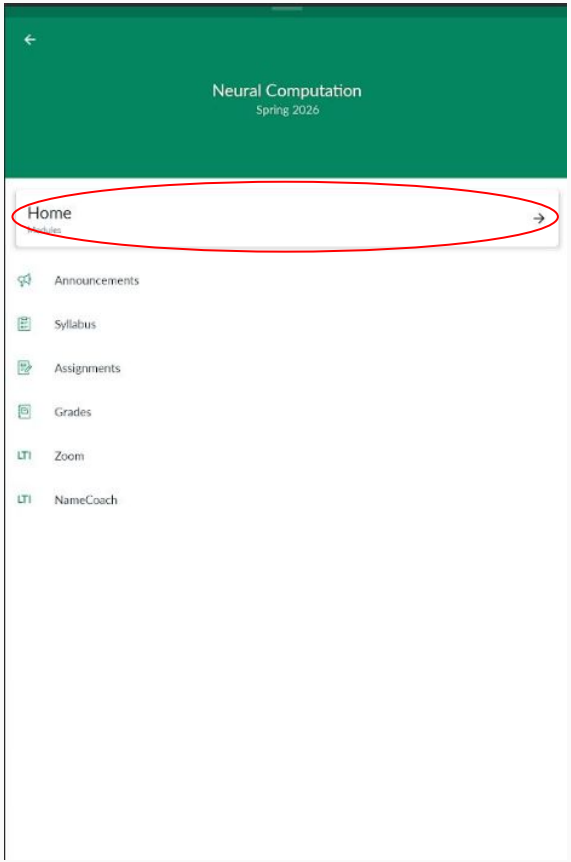

Modules
Syllabus and Logistics
15-386_686 Neural Computation Syllabus.pdf
Lecture Slides
lecture1_intro.pdf
lecture2_neuron.pdf
lecture3_spikes.pdf
lecture4_communication.pdf
lecture5_synapse.pdf
lecture6_hebbian.pdf
lecture7_selectivity.pdf
lecture8_separation.pdf
lecture9_development.pdf
Reading Materials
koch_chapter1_membrane_equation.pdf
Koch_chapter2 copy.pdf
koch_chapter6_hodgkin_huxley.pdf
koch_chapter13_plasticity.pdf
Koch_chapter14_neuron_models.pdf

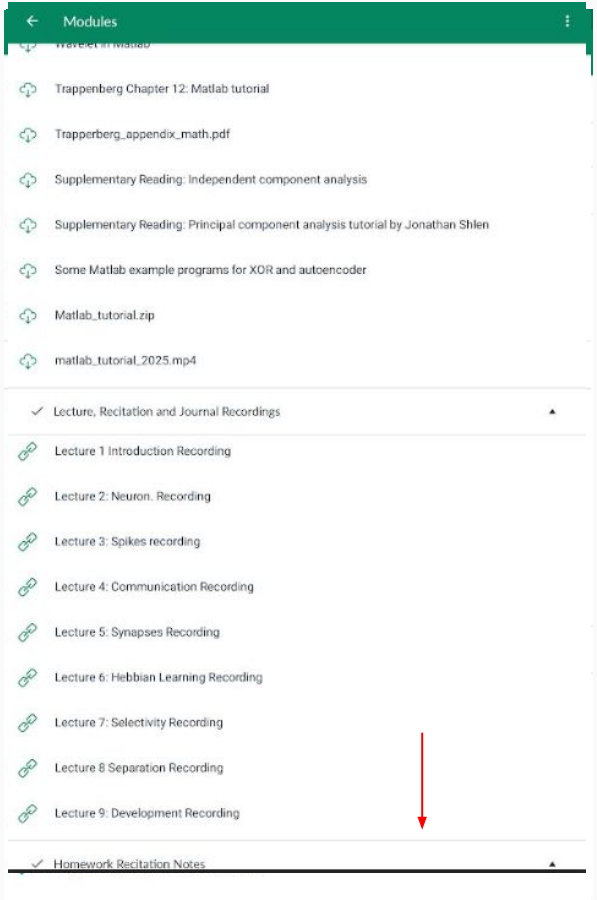

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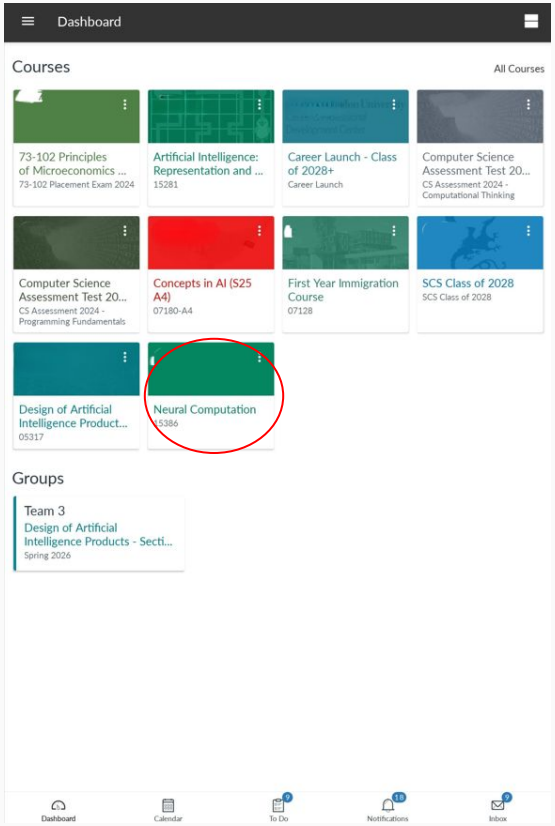

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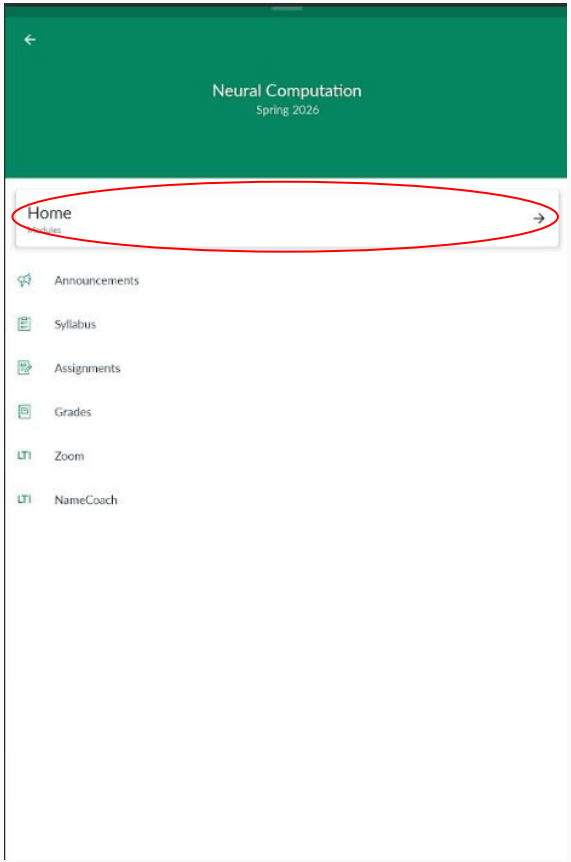

Modules
Koch_chapter14_neuron_models.pdf
abbott-Ch1__xid-1399246_1.pdf
abbott-Ch2__xid-1399248_1.pdf
Chapter3_Dayan_Abbott.pdf
Chapter5_DayanAbbott.pdf
Trappenberg_comptuational_neurosci_second_edition.pdf
Matlab tutorials and Math background
MATLAB_Recitation.zip
Recitation_Matlab.mov
Matlab Primer
Review: Math Basics
Matlab Basics
Review: Matlab basics
TA's Matlab Tutorial - Jan 26
Coding Advice 1
TA's Matlab Tutorial 2019.zip
Wavelet in Matlab
Trappenberg Chapter 12: Matlab tutorial

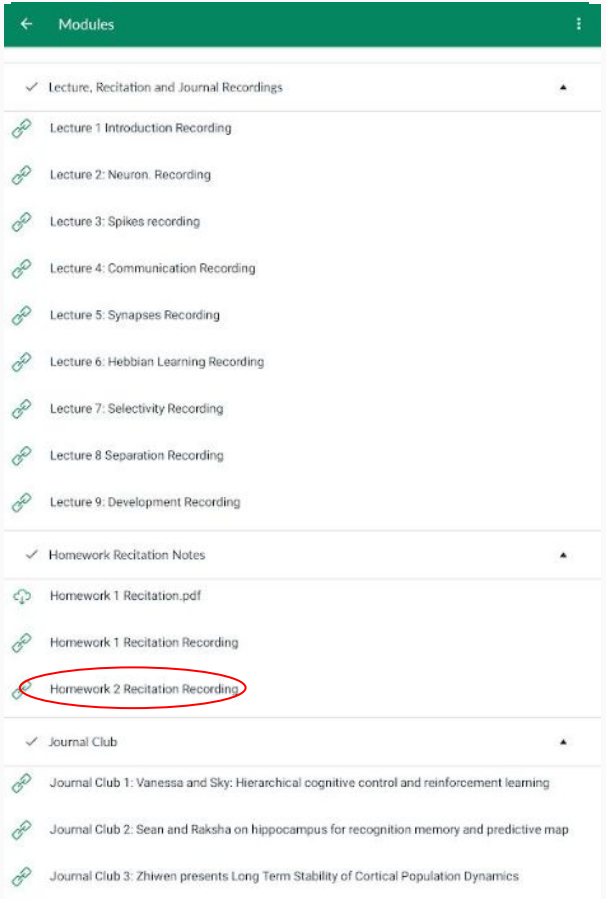

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Modules
Trappenberg Chapter 12: Matlab tutorial
Trapperberg_appendix_math.pdf
Supplementary Reading: Independent component analysis
Supplementary Reading: Principal component analysis tutorial by Jonathan Shlen
Some Matlab example programs for XOR and autoencoder
Matlab_tutorial.zip
matlab_tutorial_2025.mp4
Lecture, Recitation and Journal Recordings
Lecture 1 Introduction Recording
Lecture 2: Neuron. Recording
Lecture 3: Spikes recording
Lecture 4: Communication Recording
Lecture 5: Synapses Recording
Lecture 6: Hebbian Learning Recording
Lecture 7: Selectivity Recording
Lecture 8 Separation Recording
Lecture 9: Development Recording
Homework Recitation Notes


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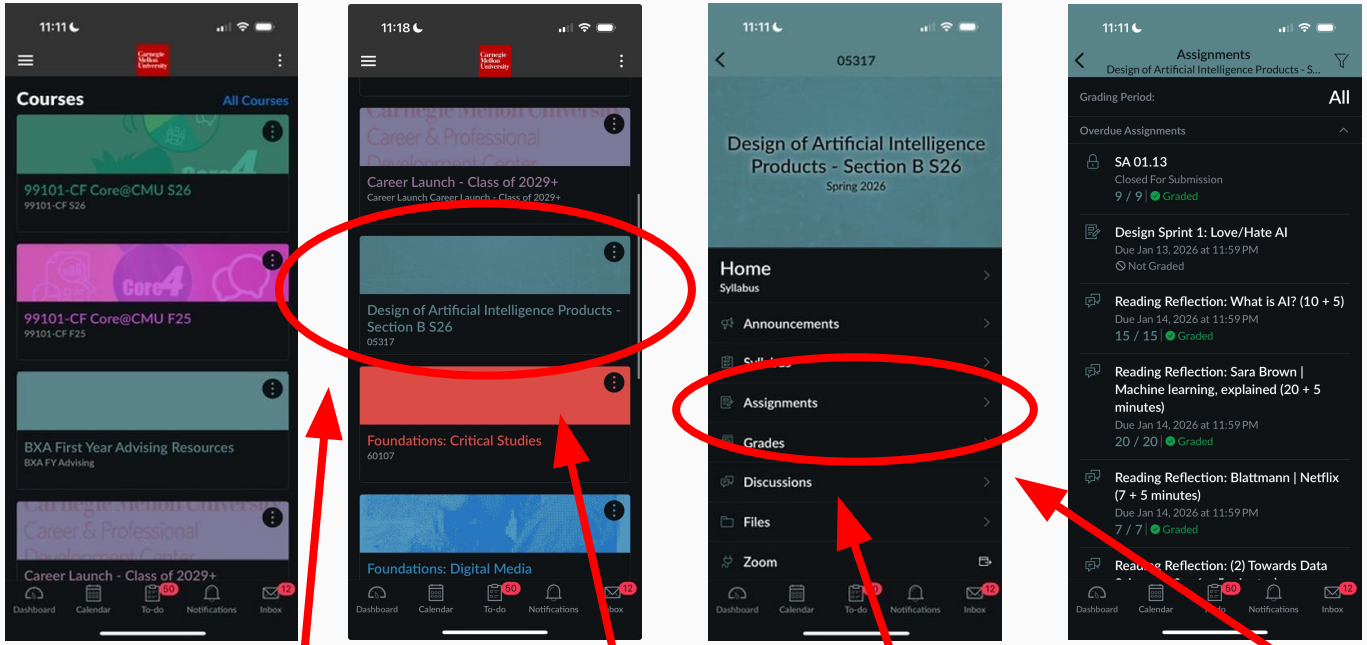

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Lecture 7: Selectivity Recording
Lecture 8 Separation Recording
Lecture 9: Development Recording
Homework Recitation Notes
Homework 1 Recitation.pdf
Homework 1 Recitation Recording
Homework 2 Recitation Recording
Journal Club
Journal Club 1: Vanessa and Sky: Hierarchical cognitive control and reinforcement learning
Journal Club 2: Sean and Raksha on hippocampus for recognition memory and predictive map
Journal Club 3: Zhiwen presents Long Term Stability of Cortical Population Dynamics

The Problem(s)

- Home page still shows earlier courses over frequently-accessed courses.
- The organization of Canvas pages relies entirely on how the teacher chooses to set up the course pages.
- As courses go on for longer, earlier lecture slides/assignments/handouts show up earlier in dropdowns (which display all items, rather than top 3 or 5).
- Even if students never use a certain tab or access a certain dropdown, the order on the homepage and Modules page is fixed and will not change over the semester.
- Difficult to locate needed materials for students, which is problematic for time-sensitive homework assignments and in-class assignments.

Current Non-adaptive Navigation



Frequently visited class not prioritized

User opens this class daily → still ranked 5th

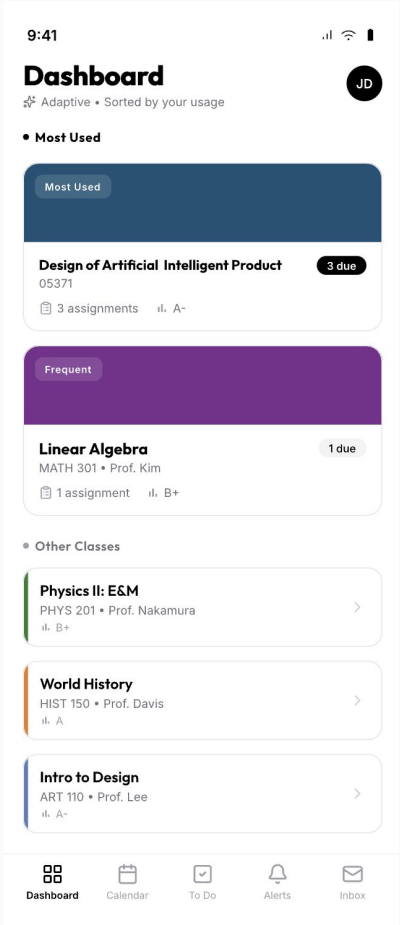
System adds friction to routine actions

Assignments accessed most → still nested equally

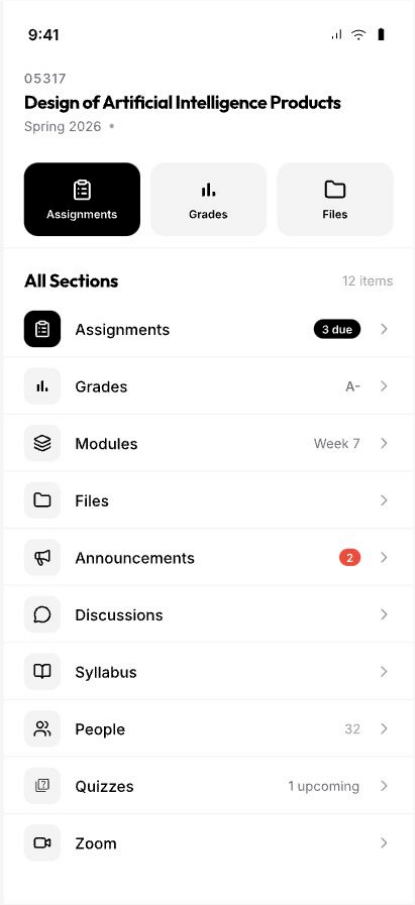
What the system does now:

- Static ordering
- Same structure for every user
- No memory of behavior

Adaptive Solution



- Courses adaptively reorder to prioritize most frequently used classes/based on the schedule
- Reduces navigation effort and improves task efficiency.



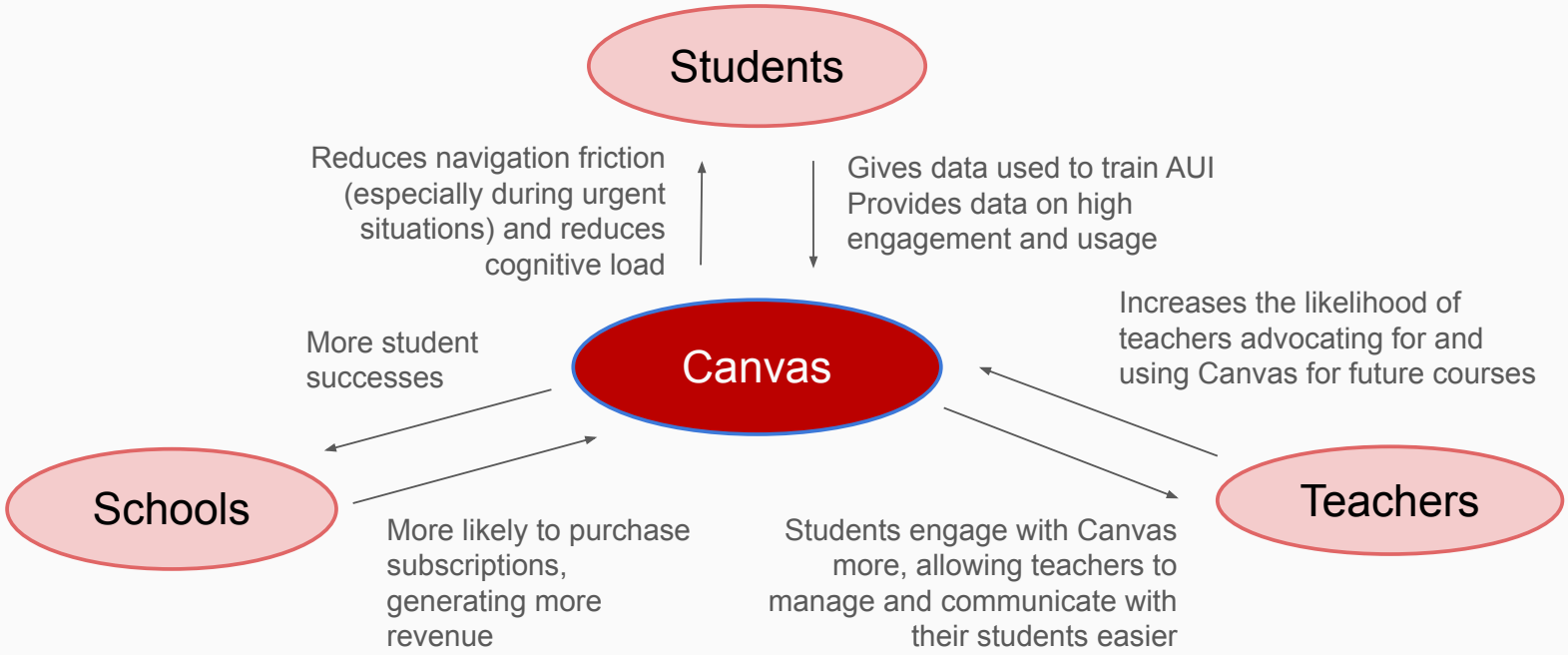
Organize Sections by Most Used

- Automatically surface most accessed sections at the top
- Preserve full section list while adaptively prioritizing high-usage items
- Reduce scrolling + navigation steps

Introduce horizontal tab bar below each class header that highlights highly used sections.

- Display the top 2–3 most accessed sections as tappable tabs
- Enable one-tap navigation to high-priority content

Co-creation of value (Value Flow Model)



Technical Feasibility

Simple Architecture

- Individual user model (no global complexity)
- Simple logistic regression model, allows for on-device training
    - Features: frequency, recency, time-of-day, day-of-week
- Lightweight cloud storage of click history
- Model trains client-side, syncs weights to cloud

Cost Structure & ROI

Development

- Full-stack engineer
- A/B test framework

Operations

- Cloud storage
- Analytics

Financial Feasibility

User & Company Applicability

- All users will be able to access their work easier
- Canvas can collect data to observe benefits of the new design
    - Market to new customers against competitors to show benefits

Cost to Develop

- Cheap to develop
    - Removing already existing content
- Cost to maintain was already present in the product

Customer Retention

- Current customers' experience will be improved
- Will reduce layers of friction between users and their work
    - Attracts new customers

Thank you!

Any Questions?

Selection

Canvas stood out since everyone in the class has had experience with Canvas and is likely aware of its UI issues. Some courses that primarily use Canvas can become quite messy and hard to navigate, even if you only use the Canvas page for a few actions. By cutting down the amount of the time user spends navigating the app, we can both increase students grades (leading to organization/customer retention) and also allow Canvas to market potential grade improvements to new institutions.
This is especially impactful because Canvas has a long list of competitors (Blackboard, Google Classroom, etc.), which means that they can always improve and market more effectively to capture a larger audience. Some of our other classes use Canvas in conjunction with other websites, like Piazza or Ed, demonstrating how Canvas isn't well-organized enough to be used on its own. We also discussed how if another competitor company created a similar application with a better interface, Canvas would likely face difficulties in obtaining new contracts. Moreover Canvas would benefit greatly from an adaptive UI.

Solution

The actual solution involves ordering the courses on Canvas and the tabs on each of the courses by what the student is most likely to click on at a given time.

For example, if a student has a class that happens at 2PM on Mondays and Wednesdays, and they tend to click the Assignments tab for that course at that time, our AUI would have that course be at the top of the list of courses and the Assignments at the top of the tabs for that course.

Repair of Inference Errors

If the AUI reorganizes classes or sections in a way that does not align with a user's needs, repair is immediate and intuitive. Users can long-press a course tab to manually reorder it, restoring their preferred layout in one simple action. They can also just scroll to the correct class if the predicted course is not the one that they want to click on at the time. Notably, Canvas currently relies on a static page structure, so even these user-driven adjustments would represent a meaningful improvement to interface navigation.

ROI calculation

From our research, we have identified that for university-sized institutions, Canvas typically charges $10/user. Since Canvas is not used by every single university, there is a lot of opportunity for Canvas to sign contracts with more institutions. Assuming 10 medium sized universities (~10,000 students) are interested in Canvas given the AUI, that's $1,000,000 revenue in contracts.

As for the development cost, the AUI would mostly involve a one time development effort. This would likely only require one full-stack engineer worth of work for ~2-3 months and a couple weeks of A/B testing, little operations/analytics cost post development (just monitoring), and little to no additional cloud cost. As a result, the development costs ~$35,000 (average full-stack developer salary for 3 months) and ~$500/month for cloud maintenance after it is developed. As a result, the ROI is much larger than 10x the cost.

Individual Crit Reflections (Isabella)

Our main takeaway from our draft pitch and critique was that the slides and pitch needed some more polishing. My slides in particular contained very blurry screenshots, and I decided that I needed to use better animations during my final pitch. Additionally, I received feedback to not make the story that I was telling personal to myself and to instead use an arbitrary character during my pitch, since in real-world settings pitches tend to include such characters.
Besides polishing my slides, I also needed to work on presenting the introduction under a minute and becoming more comfortable with what I was going to say. We used a timer during all of our practice pitches afterwards to make sure we wouldn't go overtime.

Individual Crit Reflections (Priscilla)

Through the crit, I learned that it's important to use effective visual aids to clearly communicate our point. For example, in the introduction, we got crit that it wasn't well-presented that the problem that we're trying to resolve is the need to scroll extensively to find the correct content. It was helpful to hear that we should include a visual effect where it clearly showcases the scrolling and scrolling and scrolling. I realized that the design of our slides need to be intentional for the audience to understand our point. Another crit that I appreciated was how there should be consistency in the slides whether it's the size of the fonts or the alignment of text to keep the audience engaged and show professionalism.

Individual Crit Reflections (Dora)

From the critique, my main areas for improvement became clear. First, our slides contained too much information, which made the overall flow feel heavy and visually cluttered. I realized we needed a cleaner, more consistent template that better fits the style of our app and presents the key points in a more visually appealing way.

I also needed to improve my time control during the pitch. Keeping the introduction concise and staying within the time limit required deliberate practice. In addition, we refined the transitions between slides and the hand-offs between team members, so the presentation would feel smoother and more coordinated

Individual Crit Reflections (Peter)

After the critique, we revised our slides to improve the flow and organization of the information. I realized that my slides felt overly dense, with too much text and too many screenshots competing for attention. To address this, we split the problem slide into two, which clarified the focus and reduced visual distraction. I also worked on smoothing the transition into my section of the pitch. Through in-person rehearsal, we identified a clear cue that signaled when it was time for me to begin.

Individual Crit Reflections (Davis)

After receiving critique, I learned that my slide was very cramped/text heavy. After watching other teams present, I also learned that financial feasibility is easier conveyed through numbers instead of text. Because of this, I removed some of the text on my slide and included some rough “back of the napkin” math to give the viewer an estimate of the ROI this product would produce. After making these changes, I immediately realized how much more readable the financial feasibility slide was. By moving most of the explanation to my script and speech, I cleared up the slide to focus on just the important information that I needed to convey to the audience to really drive my point home.

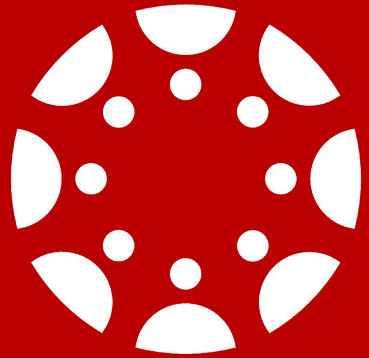
Individual Crit Reflections (Caroline)

Prior to the critique, the slide that I was mostly working on (the technical feasibility slide) was a blank slide with text on it. After going through the critique, hearing feedback from Jodi and other teams, and also seeing other team's slides, I realized that visuals were very important in effectively communicating and that more text on slides did not necessarily mean good communication of thought. As a result, after the critique, I modified the slide so that it was more visual and conveyed what I had wanted to say in text in the form of a simple architecture diagram and a simple visual for operations. I felt more confident re-doing these slides after the critique as well, given that I had a better understanding of what others thought would best communicate my ideas. It helped that I had written a script beforehand and knew exactly what I wanted my images to communicate and what was not necessarily to include on the slide (in the form of text) because I would be speaking it out loud.

Final Pitch

Canvas QuickClick

Team 3:
Caroline Shi, Isabella Webber, Peter Shpelfogel,
Priscilla Park, Dora Chen, Davis Germain



Canvas Quick Click

Problem

Solution

Co-creation of Value

Technical Feasibility

Financial feasibility



Name: Derek
Occupation: CMU student

Canvas Quick Click

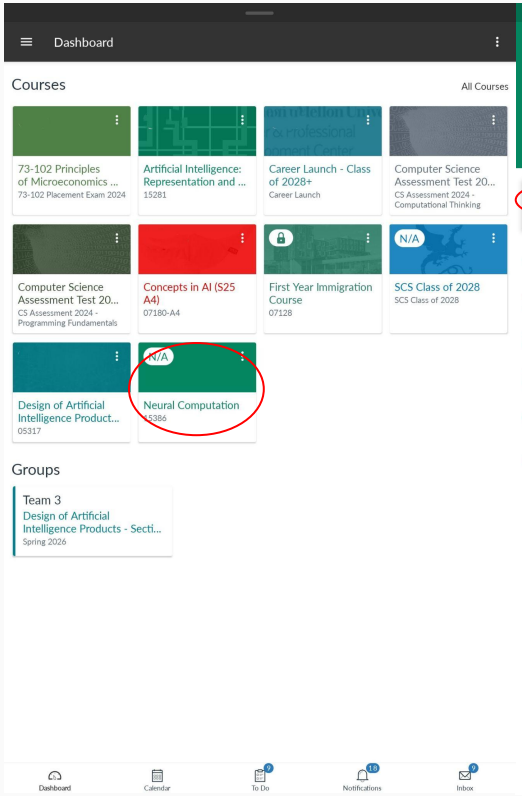
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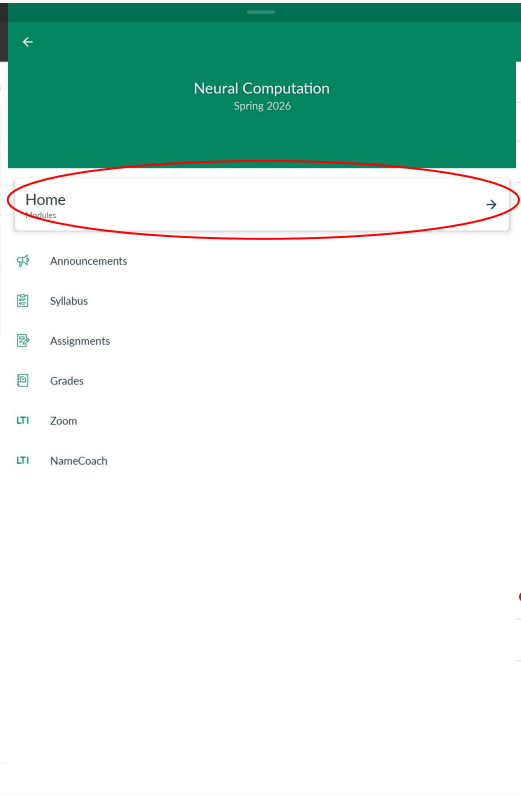
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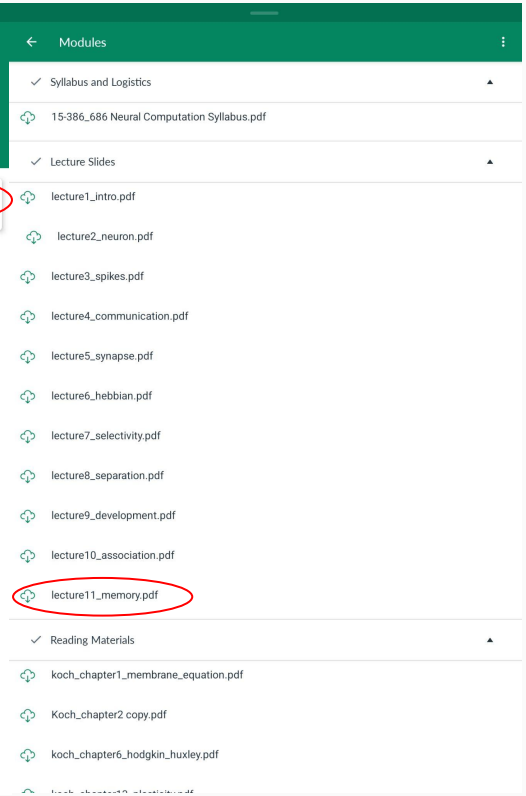
Co-creation of Value

Technical Feasibility

Financial feasibility







Canvas Quick Click

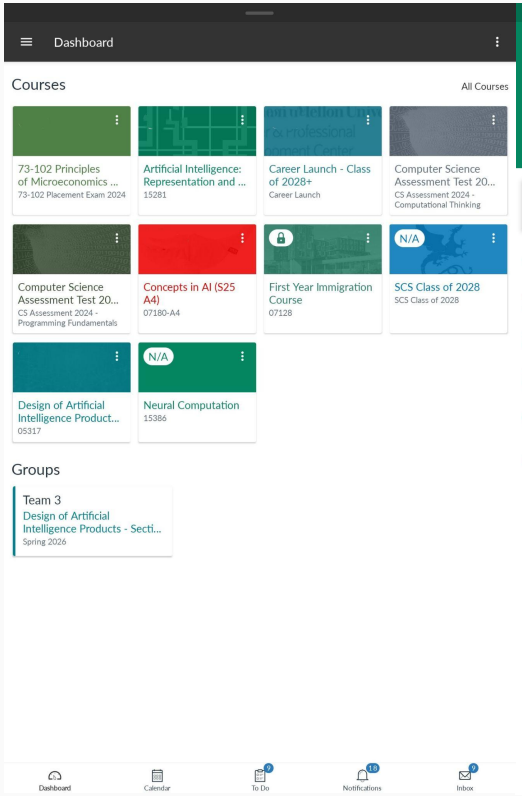
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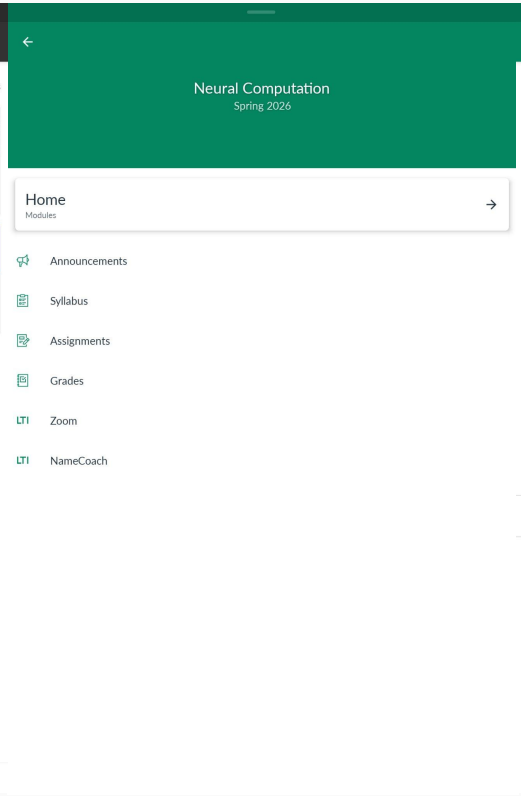
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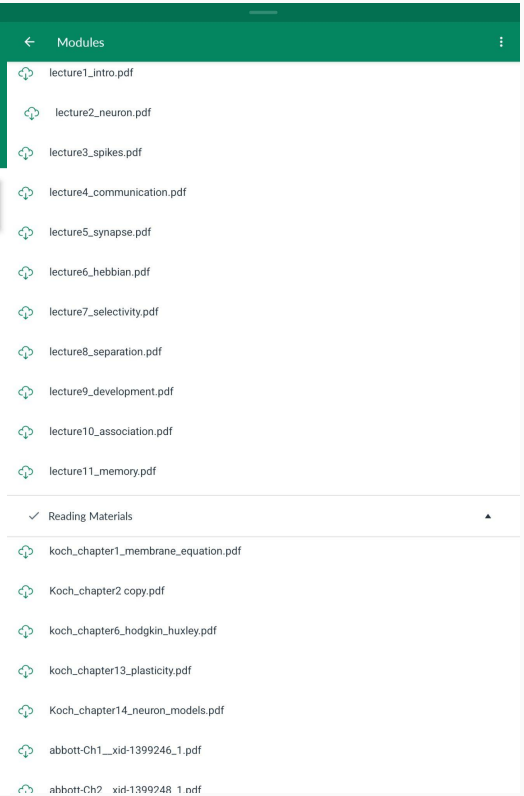
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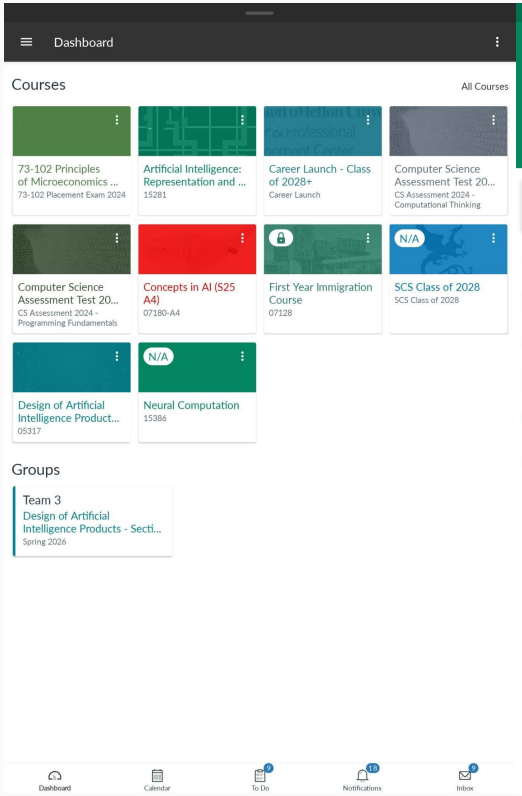
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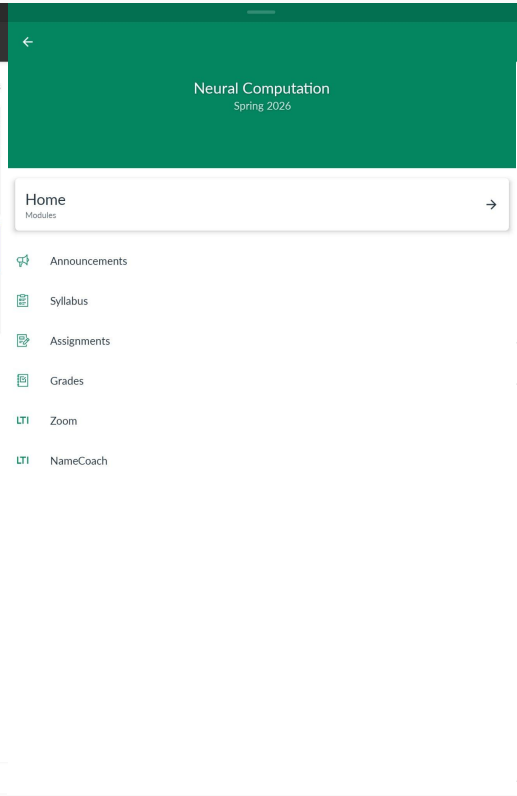
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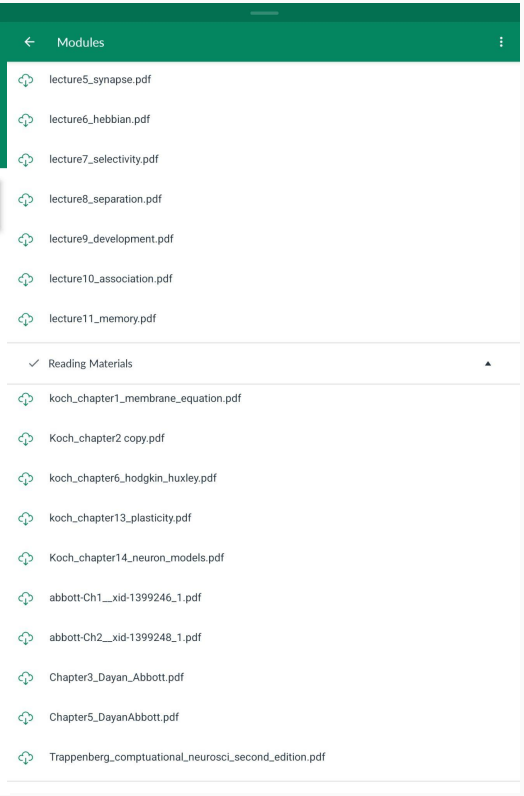
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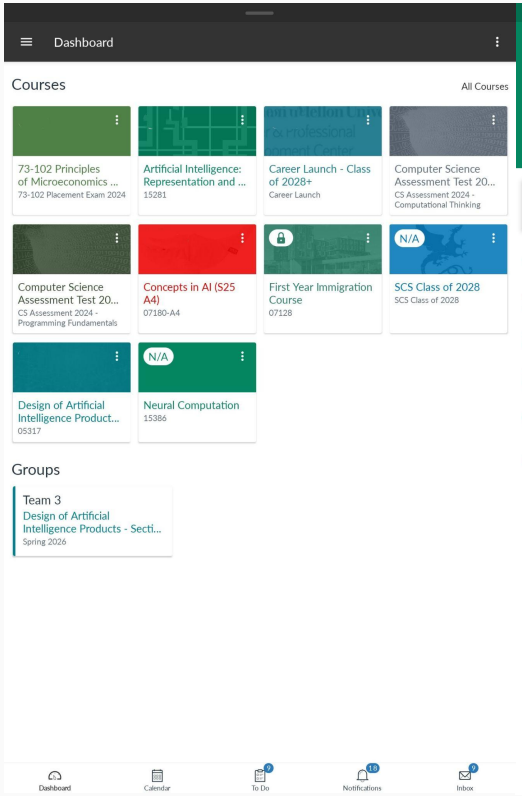
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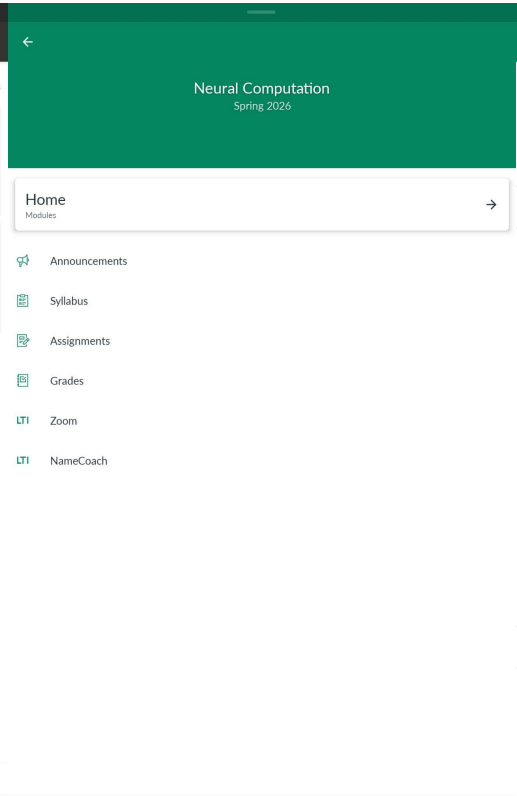
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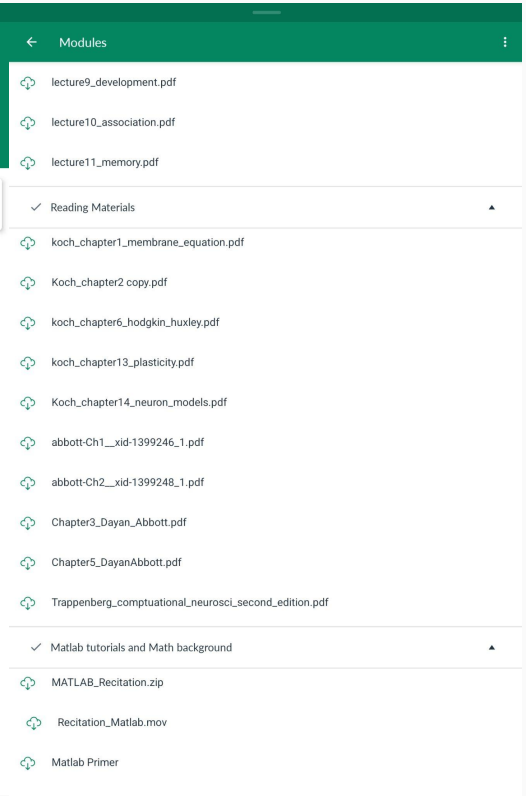
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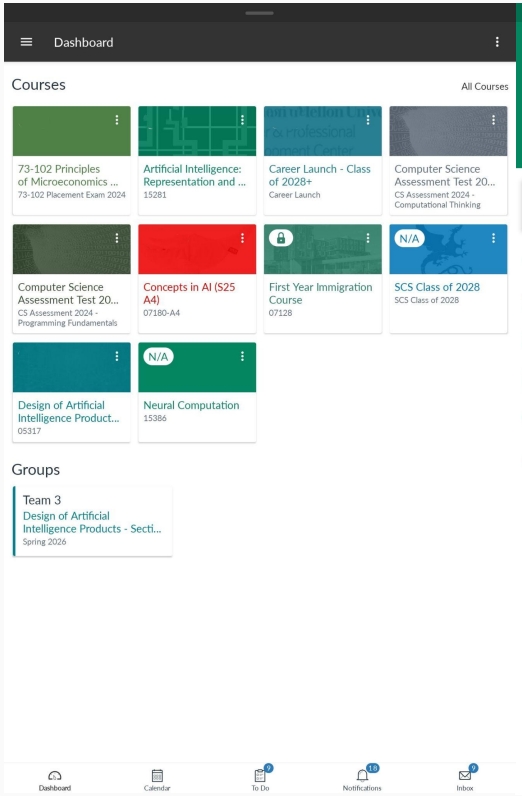
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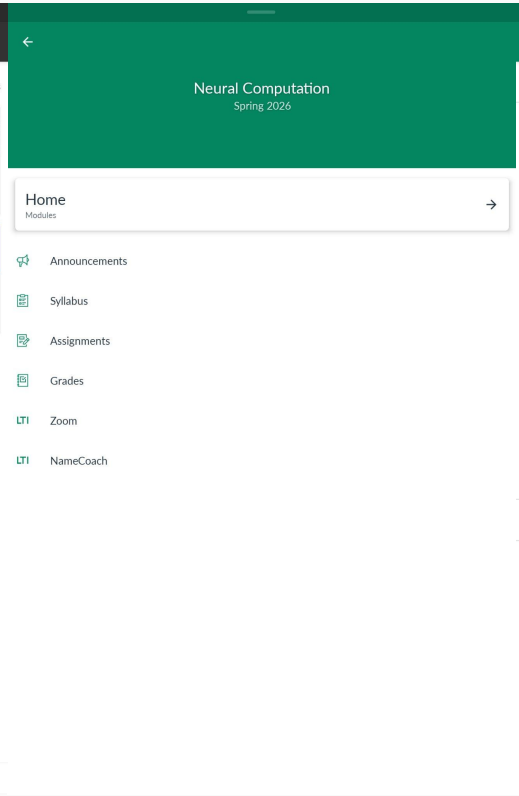
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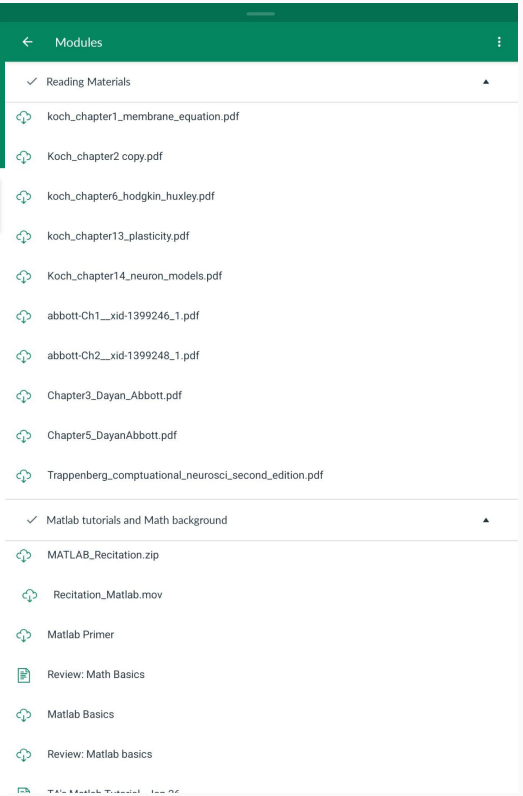
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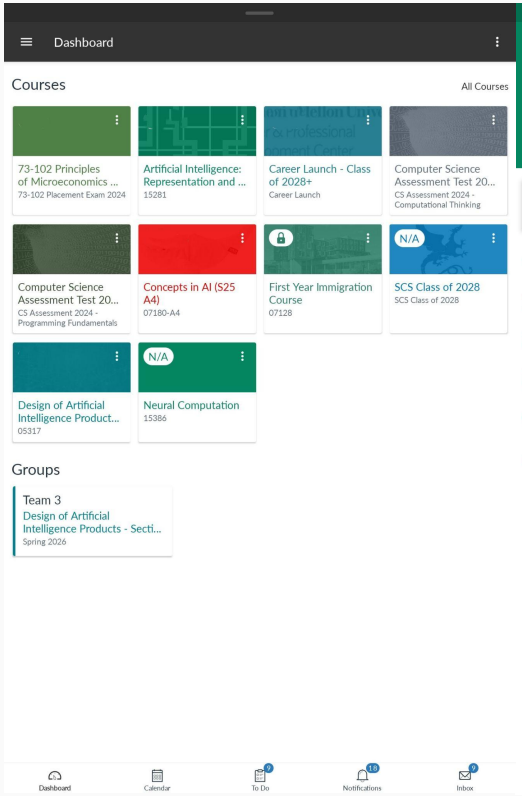
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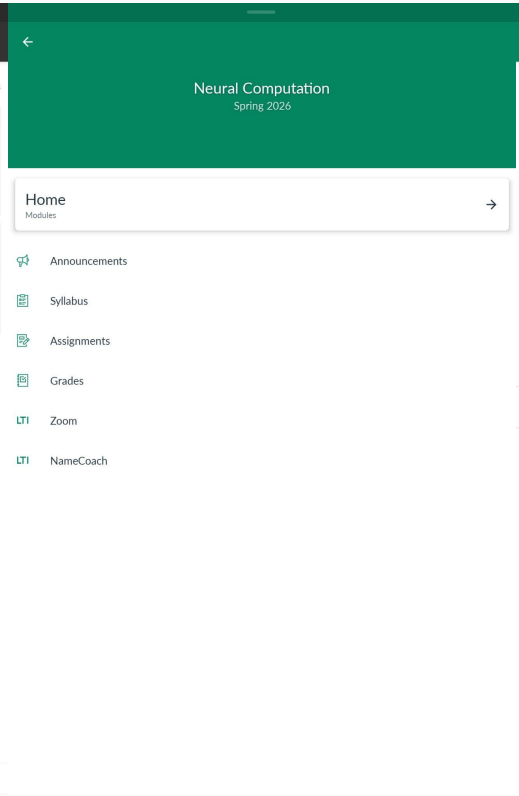
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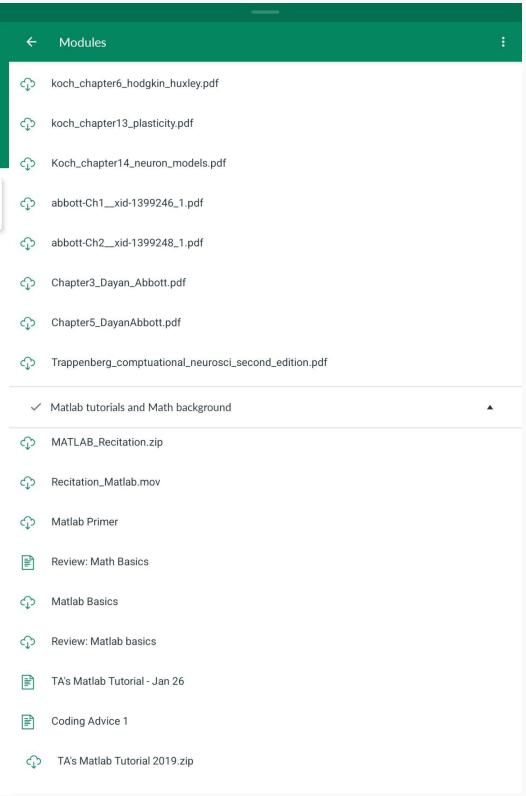
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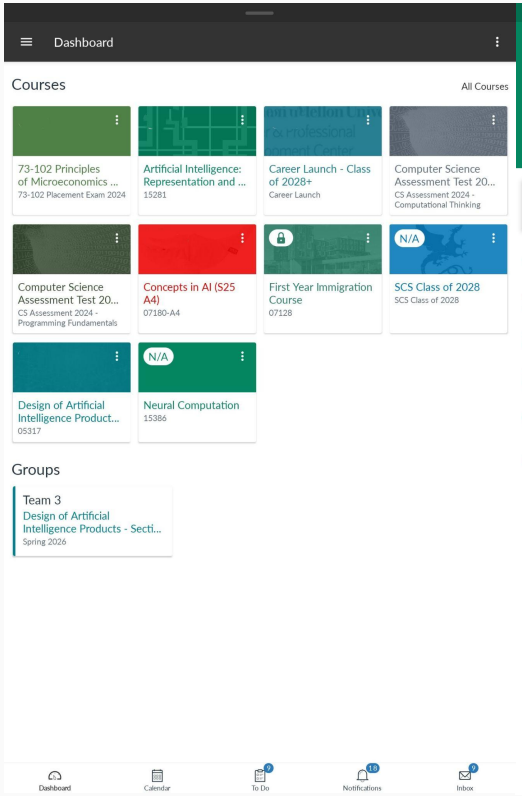
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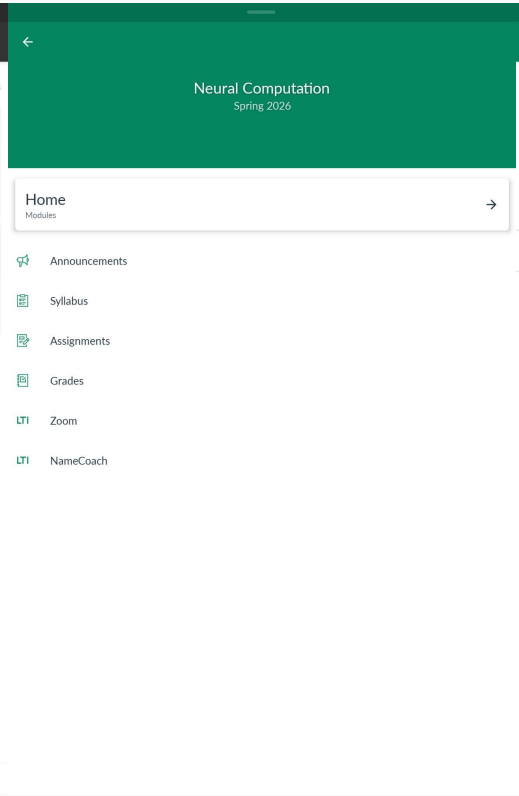
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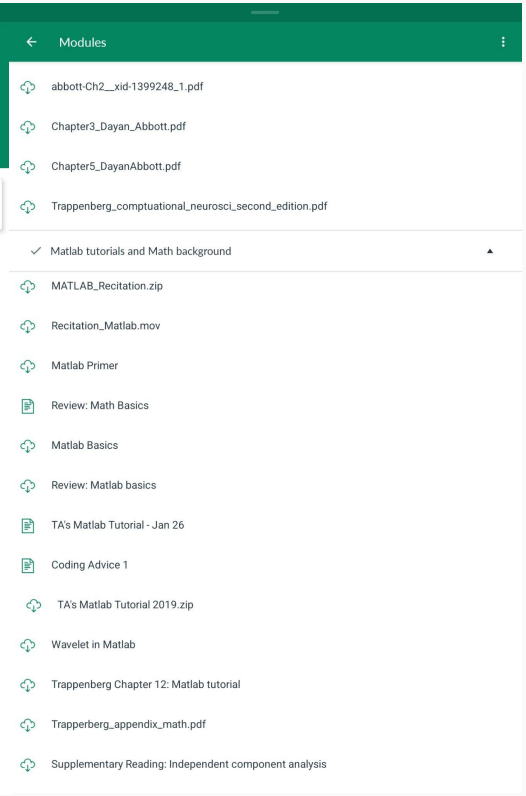
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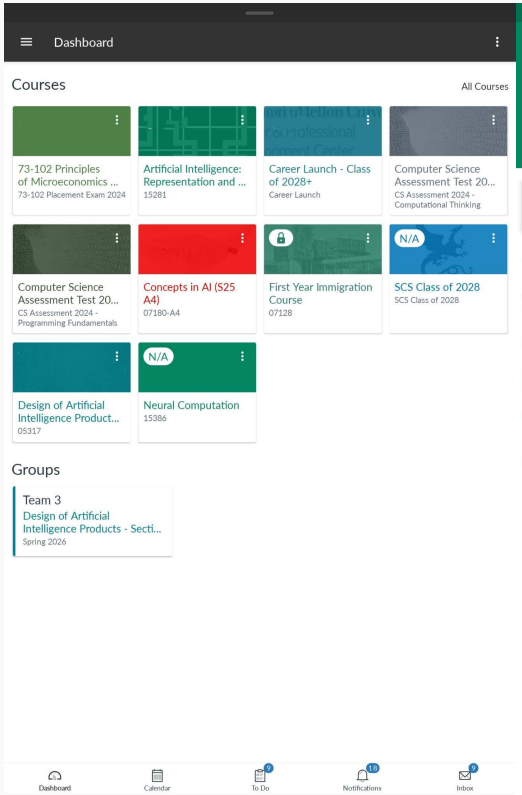
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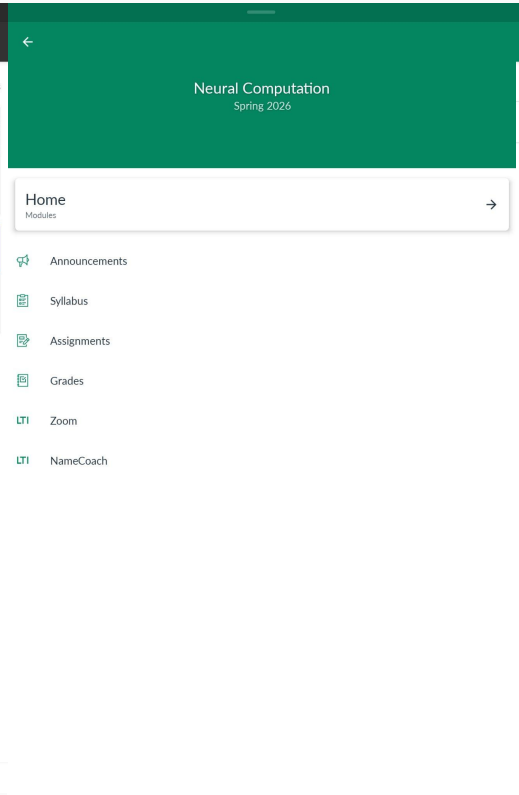
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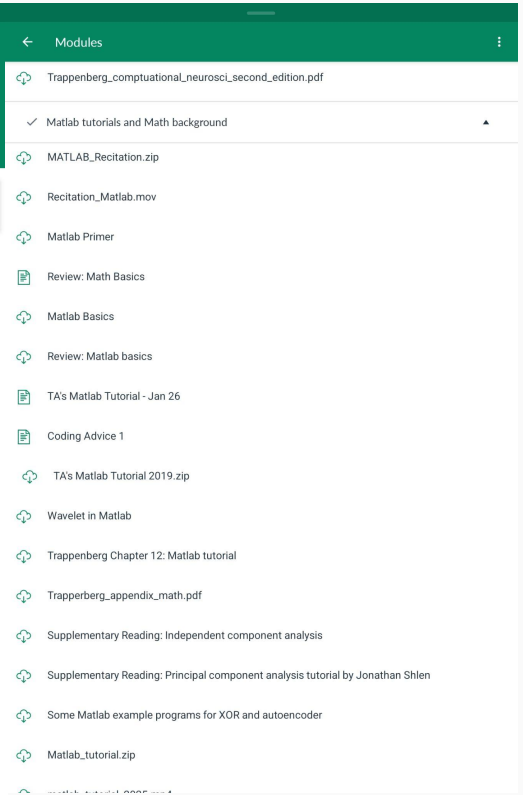
Co-creation of Value

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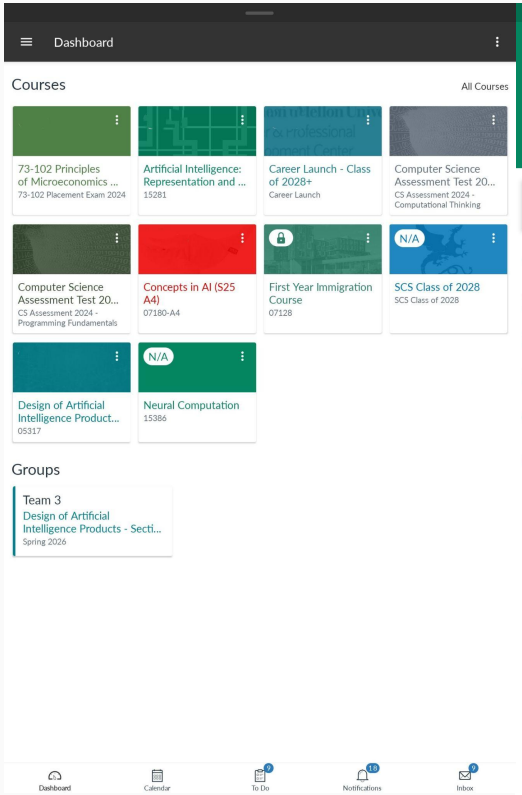
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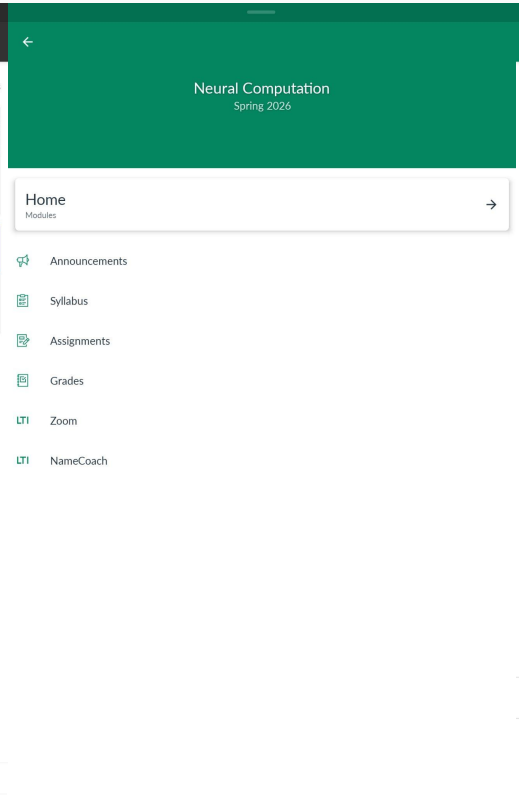
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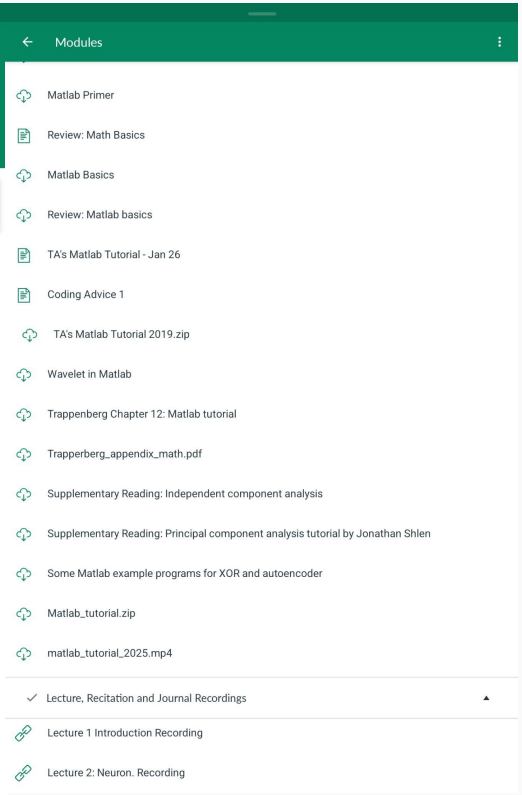
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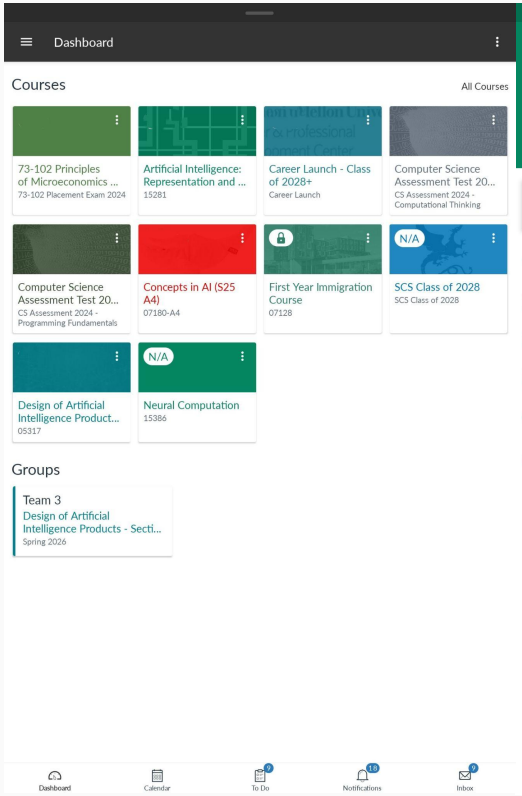
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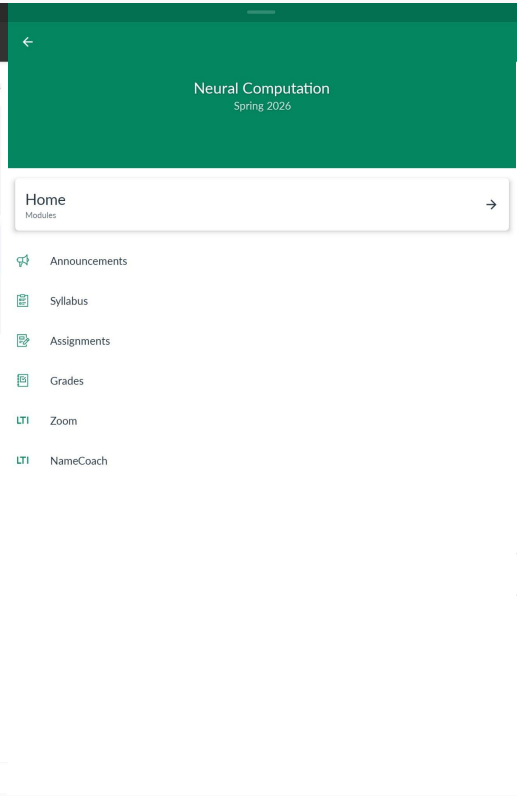
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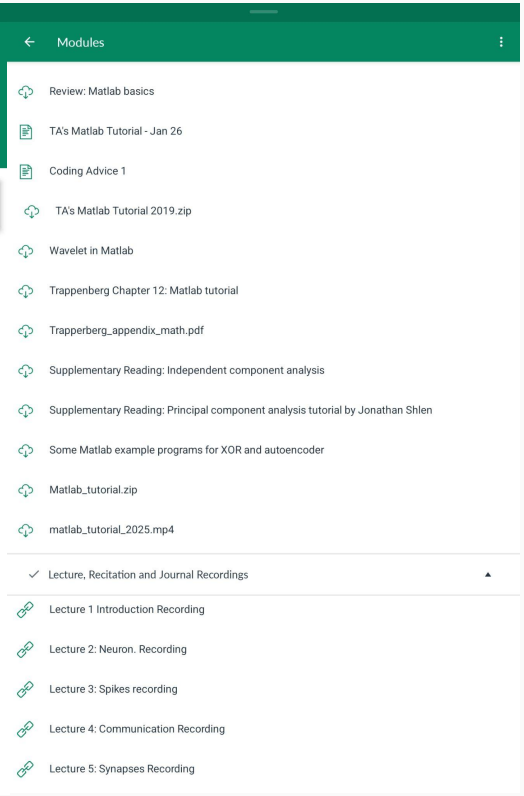
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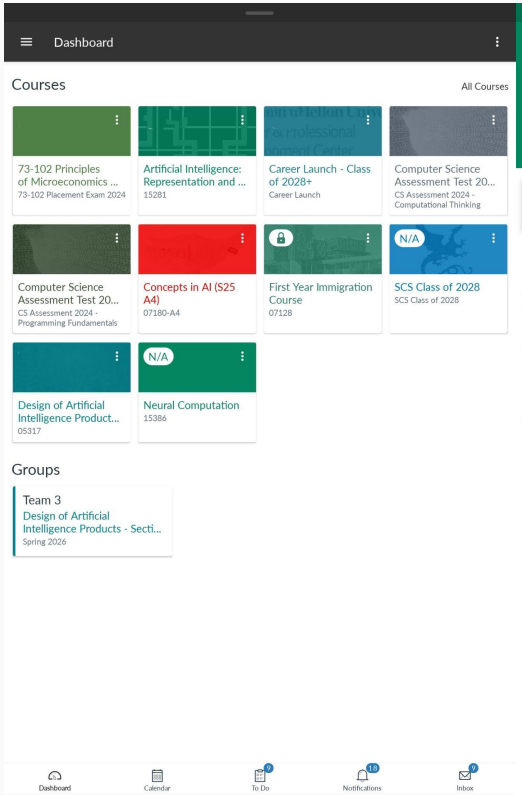
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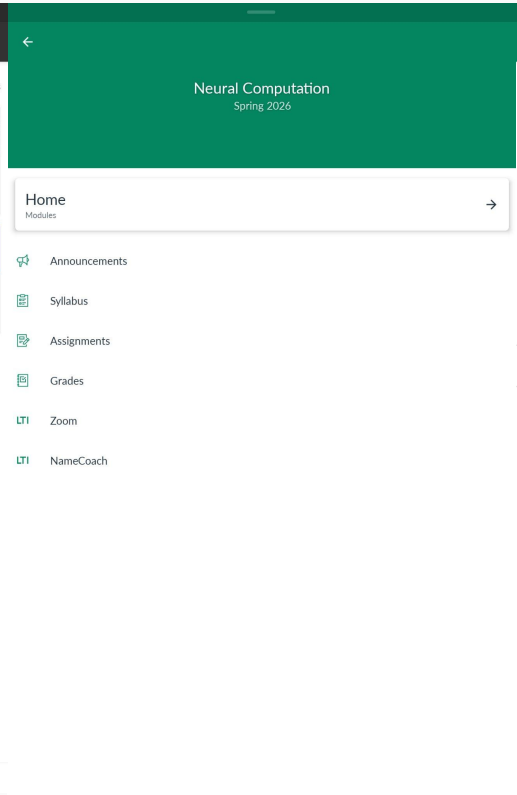
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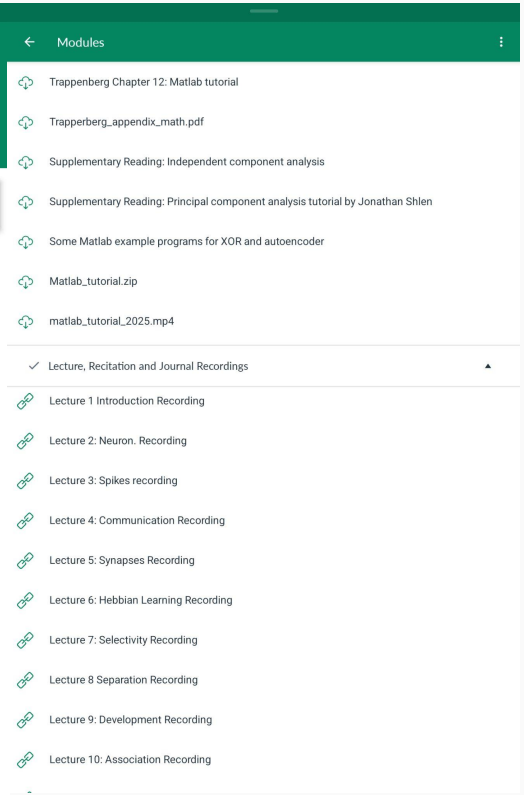
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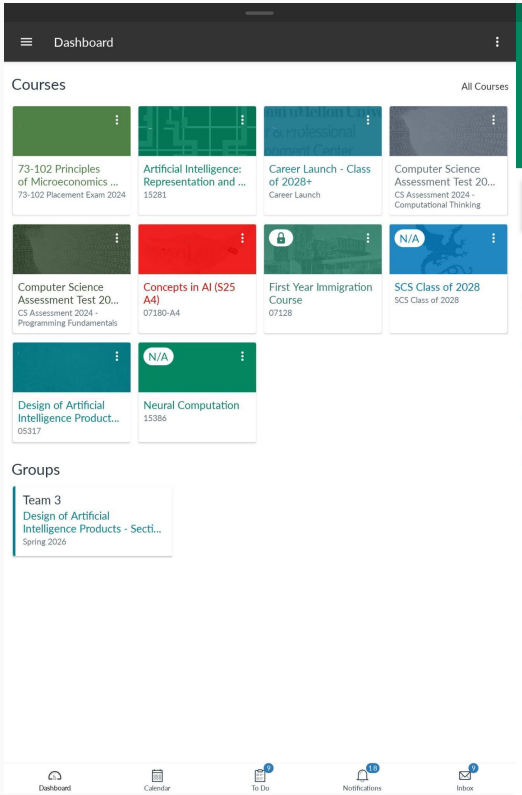
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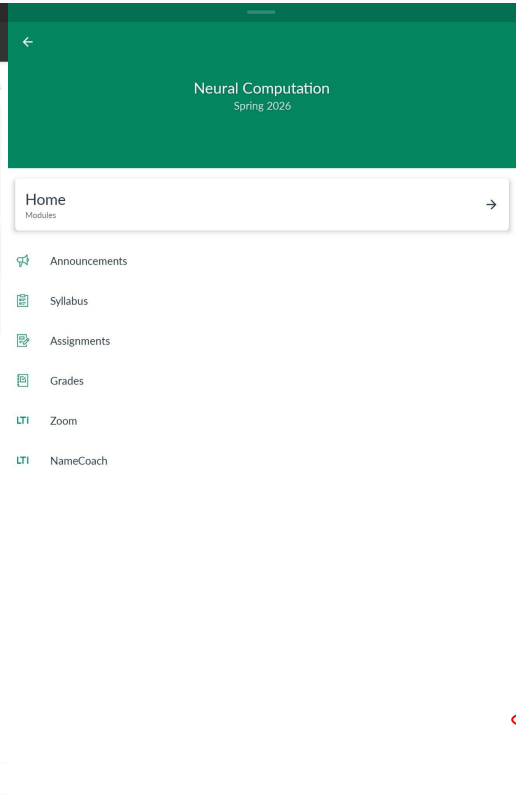
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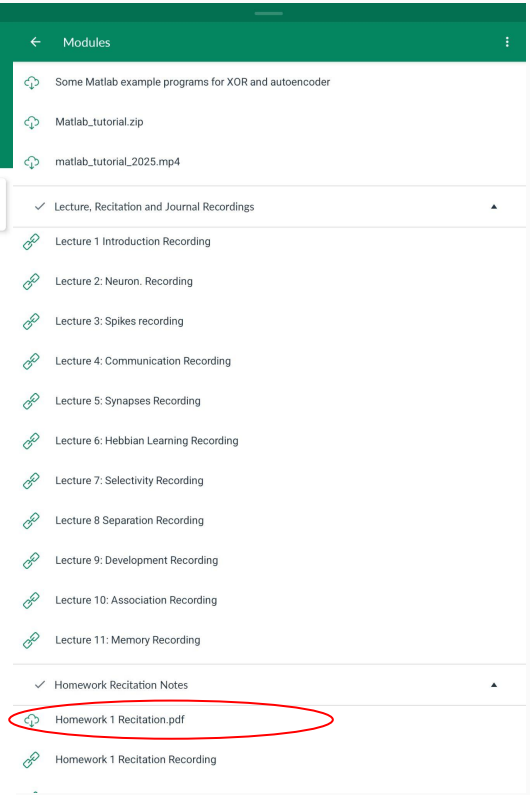
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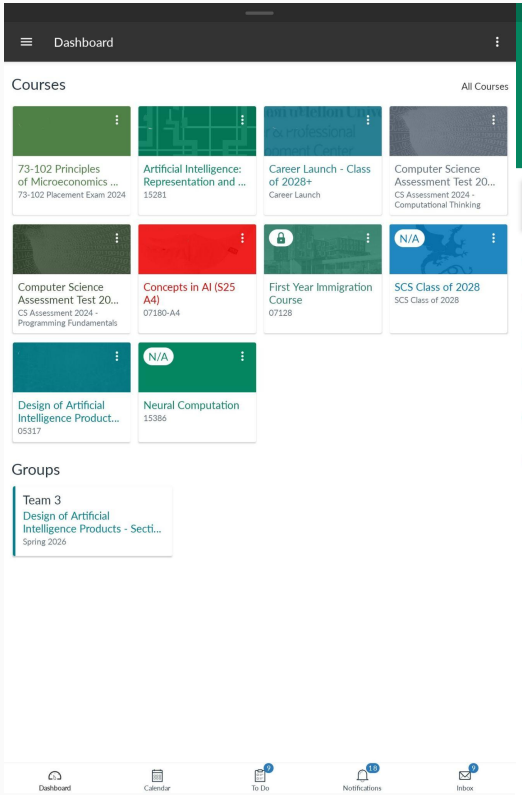
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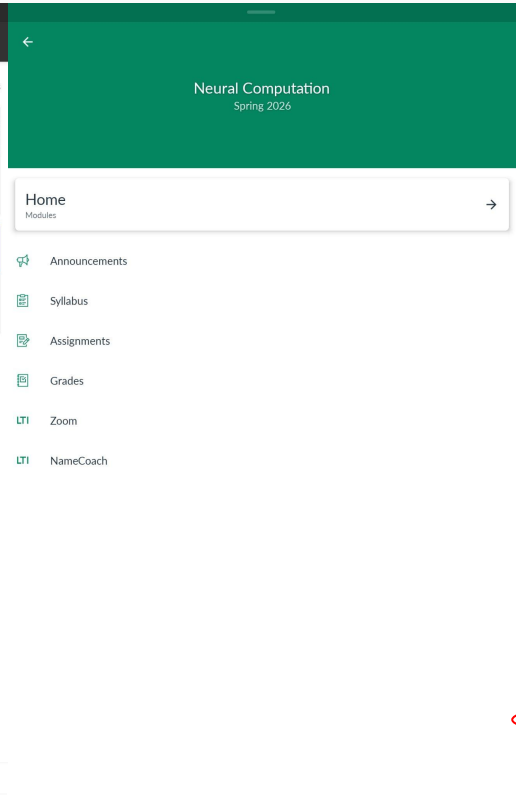
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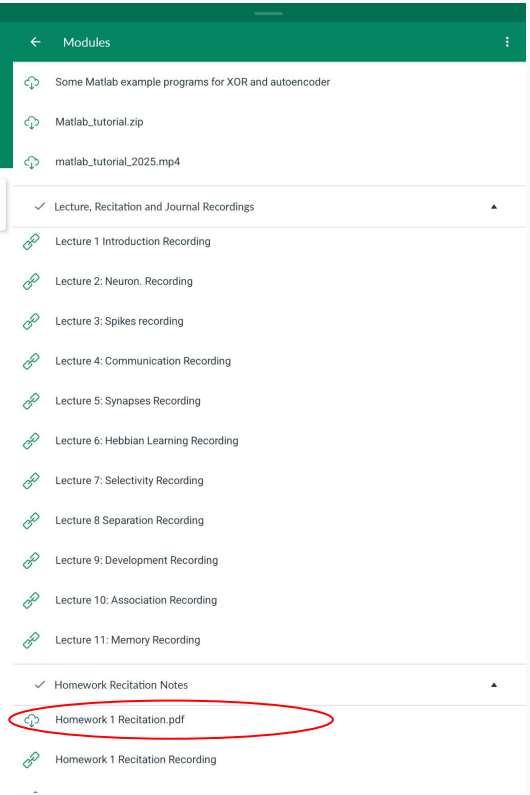
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Canvas Quick Click

Problem

Solution

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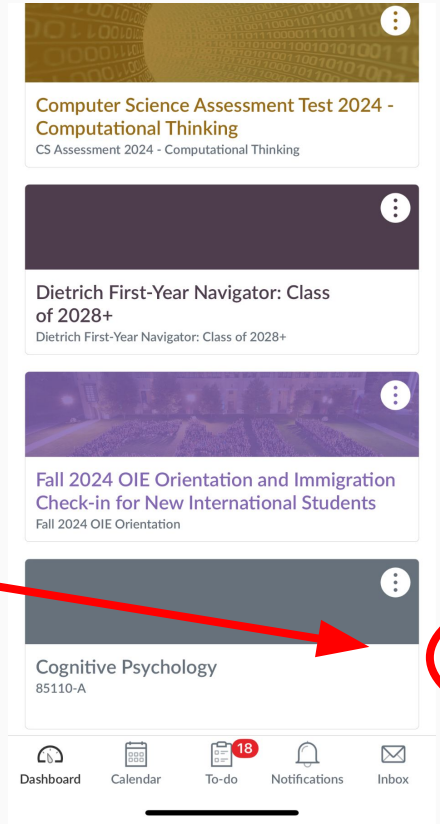
Current Non-adaptive Navigation

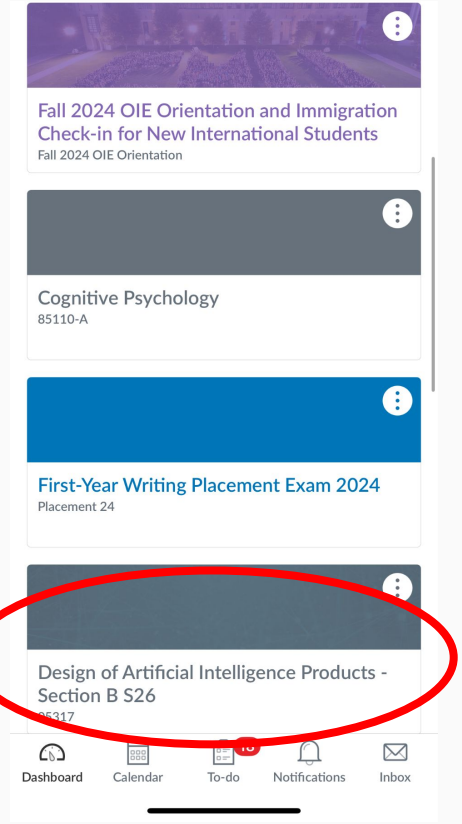
What the system does now:

- Static ordering
- Same structure for every user
- No memory of behavior

Frequently visited class not prioritized

User opens this class daily → still ranked 6th





Canvas Quick Click

Problem

Solution

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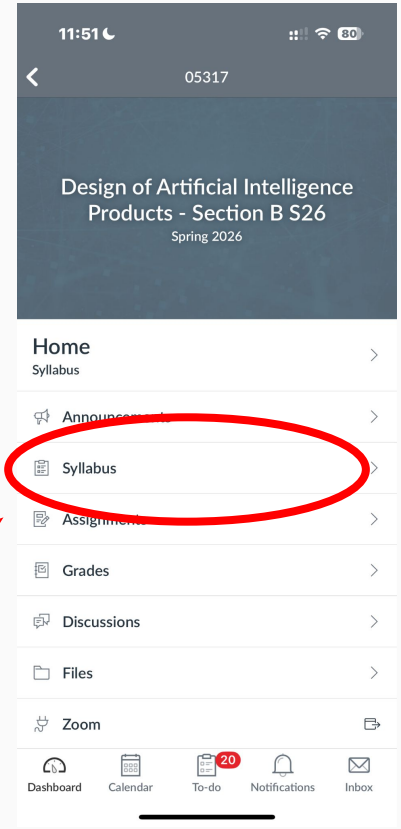
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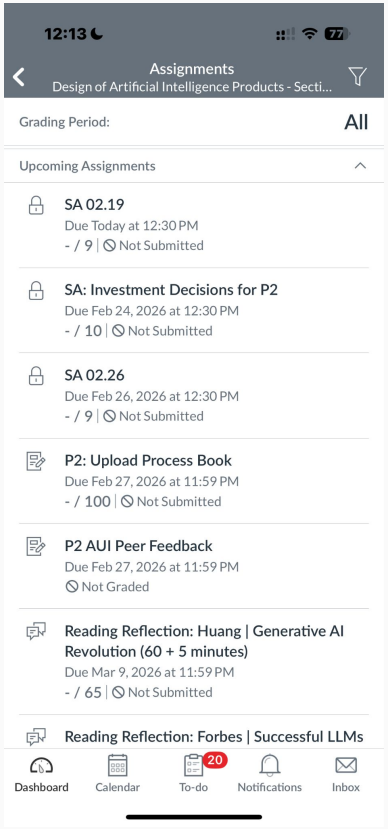
What the system does now:

- Static ordering
- Same structure for every user
- No memory of behavior

System adds friction to routine actions

Assignments accessed most → still nested equally





Canvas Quick Click

Problem

Solution

Co-creation of Value

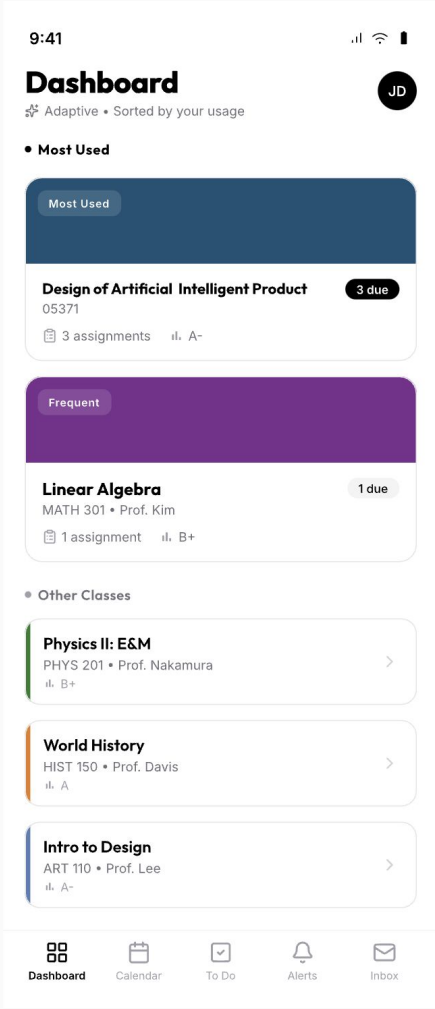
Technical Feasibility

Financial feasibility

Adaptive Navigation

Courses adaptively reorder on the dashboard

- Prioritize the most frequently used classes, based on user interaction/schedule patterns.
- Reduces navigation effort and improves task efficiency.



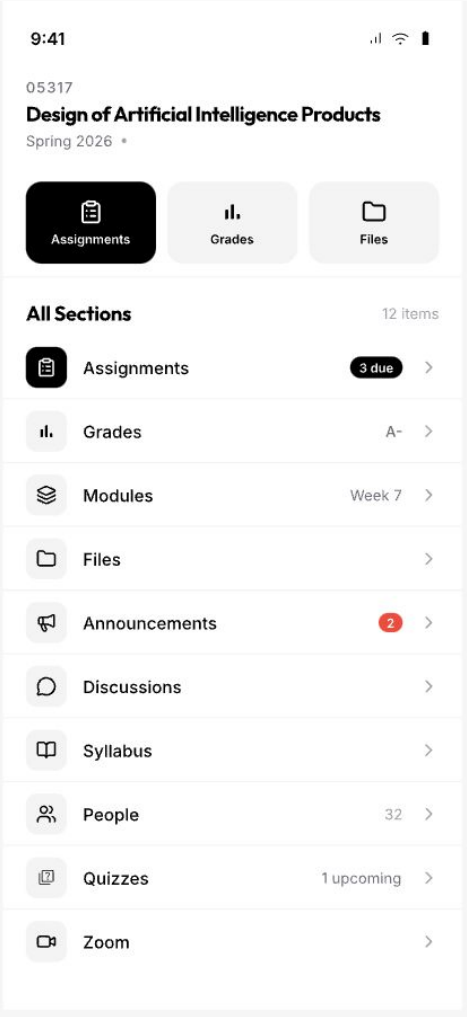
Adaptive Navigation

Organize Sections by Most Used

- Automatically surface most accessed sections at the top
- Reduce scrolling + navigation steps

Introduce horizontal tab bar

- Display the top 2–3 most accessed sections as tappable tabs
- Enable one-tap navigation to high-priority content



Co-Creation of Value



Students

- Reduces navigation friction (especially during urgent situations) and reduces cognitive load



Teachers

- Students engage with Canvas more, allowing teachers to manage and communicate with their students easier

Co-Creation of Value



Universities

- More student successes
- Higher student satisfaction and institutional reputation

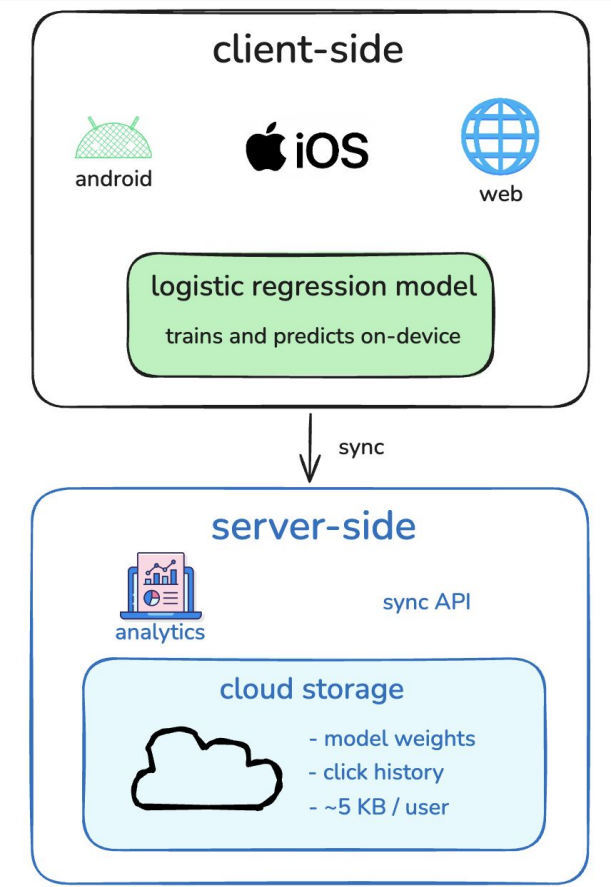


Canvas Business

- Gives data used to train AUI
  Provides data on high engagement and usage
- More subscriptions purchases, generating more revenue

Technical Feasibility

Simple Architecture

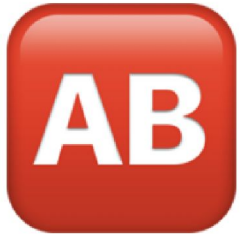


Cost Structure & ROI

Development



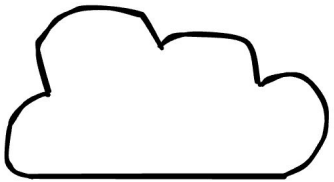
fullstack engineer



A/B testing



analytics



cloud storage

Financial Viability

Canvas contracts = ~**$10**/user.

$10/user * 10 new universities * 10,000 students **= $1,000,000**
Quick Click costs ~$50,000 to develop, **10-20x ROI**

User & Company Applicability

All users will be able to access their work easier
Canvas can collect data to market benefits to new organizations

Cost to Develop

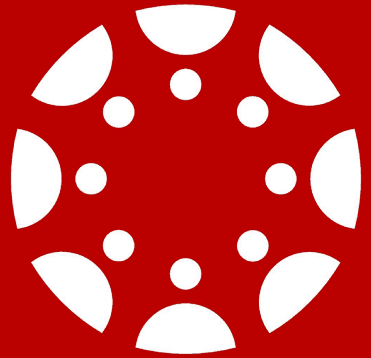
- Cheap to develop
  - Reorganizing already existing content
- Cost to maintain already present in Canvas

Customer Retention

- Current user experience will be improved

Thank You!

Questions?



Individual Final Reflection (Isabella)

P2 helped me realize that pitching an idea correctly is just as important as coming up with the right idea. Designing and practicing the pitch took more time than when we were just discussing design choices for the wireframes. Additionally, I was drawn to pitches that had a strong introduction, and I ranked these pitches higher.

This project also made me realize how many opportunities there are for adaptive AUIs; I think that many of our other ideas could have worked as well. I also think that adaptive AUIs is one of the low-hanging fruits with designing with AI since in most cases it is easy to implement error correction for inference errors that the AI might make.

Individual Final Reflection (Davis)

Overall, I think I benefited from working with this team a lot. Starting from the very beginning of ideation and taking it to pitching a medium-fidelity product showed me the ropes of how products and ideas start. It was also nice to build off of the matchmaking process we learned in the last project, and use that to select the company we wanted to create an AUI for. The hardest part for me was getting down the pitch, because it was the culmination of all of our team's work and I wanted to showcase the effort we put into our Canvas QuickClick AUI properly. Now that I understand how to materialize my ideas into real product pitches, I will definitely use the skill for future design classes at CMU and into the workforce.

Individual Final Reflection (Priscilla)

P2 helped me how to thoroughly search for opportunities and analyze potential opportunities by evaluating the co-creation of value, the flow up to trigger, the inference that the system makes, and the frequency of users utilizing the AUI. Beyond my own research, I realized the importance of collaborating in a group of people with such diverse backgrounds and skills. We all brought valuable perspectives, took initiative, and completed all our parts on time, which allowed us to work smoothly without any major obstacles and produce our best work.

As a business and HCI student, I've always kept the two fields separate, but this project helped me to approach designing AUI in the lens of improving the user experience but also producing financial value to the company. It was also a rewarding process, as I was able to contribute my skills in designing pitch slide decks and implementing user persona storytelling.

Individual Final Reflection (Dora)

P2 really helped me step into the product and see it from the user's perspective. By putting myself in users' shoes, I began to think more deeply about what problems they might encounter while using the software, and what simple AUI approaches could effectively address those pain points. Beyond the design work itself, I also learned a lot from the collaboration process. Everyone brought diverse ideas and personal experiences to the table, which broadened my perspective and made the discussions and brainstorming sessions both insightful and enjoyable.

Individual Final Reflection (Caroline)

I think working on P2 and with a group of people to design an AUI and pitch it was a good experience that I have never had before. I have gone through processes of ideating and creating prototypes in previous HCI classes (specifically 05-391), but what was new to me was pitching the design and thinking of all the business aspects of what the pitch would involve. From the beginning, when we were initially brainstorming and then picking our AUI, I found it helpful to be able to talk with everyone about their opinions on which AUI provided the best business value, as I thought I did not have a very good gauge of financial viability. Additionally, throughout the entire process of creating the AUI design and putting together the pitch, I found it helpful to have other people to discuss what we wanted our design to look like and to have people to bounce ideas off of. It definitely helped me feel much more confident in our final pitch and design.

Individual Final Reflection (Peter)

This project challenged me to think more intentionally about how adaptive user interfaces shape user experience. The ideation phase was my favorite part, as it pushed me to critically analyze everyday mobile apps rather than use them passively. The most challenging aspect was presenting, since I realized I experience anxiety when sharing academic work with a larger audience.
I don't often collaborate with peers in technical disciplines, so I was especially grateful to work with students who were well versed in the technical capabilities of AUIs. This allowed me to better understand how these systems function in practice. Executing this project with students from different years and majors also broadened my perspective and exposed me to diverse approaches to ideation, problem-solving, and workflow. Overall, the project deepened my understanding of adaptive user interfaces, made me more aware of how embedded they are in the apps I use daily, and strengthened my ability to pitch design ideas.

Thank you!

P2 Process Book: AUI